Catra in Wakanda

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Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Major Character Death

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F/F, F/M

Fandoms:
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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Nakia (Black Panther)/T'Challa, Shuri & T'Challa (Marvel), Ramonda & Shuri & T'Challa (Marvel), Nakia (Black Panther) & Shuri, T'Challa & Catra (She-Ra), Shuri & Catra (She-Ra), Ramonda & Catra (She-Ra), Nakia (Black Panther) & Catra (She-Ra), Everett Ross & Catra (She-Ra), Everett Ross & T'Challa

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Additional Tags:
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Catra in Wakanda

by Portal_Master_Mania1

Summary

When Catra wakes up in a strange lab run by a 16 year old girl, she never imagined that this new location would be a doorway to a new adventure. But with recurring nightmares, none of her friends, and a serious lack of understanding of this new land, will the feline Etherian be able to make it in Wakanda?

The Alien

Shuri had been devastated when she received the news of her father's passing in the terrorist attack. She held no resentments towards anyone for it, but it still hurt worse than any wound. She was wandering around the border of her homeland of Wakanda, getting some fresh air and trying to relax, but for her it was easier to relax whilst she was working, it didn't help that as a prodigy, she found every task she was set too easy. Little did she know that someone would fall out of the sky and into her life very soon, and this person would bring about a change to how Wakanda saw things.

As Shuri was about to head back to her home, she saw something unusual, it looked like a swirling, golden, upside-down tornado that was floating about a story in the air just outside the border, it had just manifested itself in front of her eyes! Something like a pulse of energy rippled from the centre to the edges, and with a boom, a figure plummeted from it and crashed to the ground! With that, the tornado-thing faded away, leaving the figure as the only sign that it was there. Shuri was quick to run through the border and to check on the figure. Whatever it was, at least it was alive, she could see a few members of the Border Tribe rushing up to them, and she was glad to see her brother's friend, W'Kabi, leading them, but even he gasped at the sight of this figure, and on inspection, Shuri could tell this was, despite having a similar form, not a human: it looked female with a slender, tan-skinned character of feline origins with athletic body physics. She had angular features, such as a pointed chin, straight nose, and slanted, almond-shaped eyes. She had three freckles on her cheeks, and soft curving dark eyebrows. She also had small fangs, large, black, catlike ears slightly buried within her hair, a long prehensile dark brown cat tail, and light brown horizontal markings on her arms, with three on her back that resembled a tabby cat's stripes. She also sported short and messy cedar brown hair. She was wearing a reddish leotard, with a black garment that

covered her collar, she also had a small, diamond-shaped opening above her chest, and around her waist was a black belt. She had burgundy and black leggings, and she was barefoot. All her clothes had rips and tears in them and whoever this was had quite a few injuries. Now, Shuri knew this was an outsider, but she just had a feeling that she should help her,

"W'Kabi?" she asked, "help me get her to my lab"

Catra's eyes were heavy, and everything hurt. As she finally managed to open her eyes, she could see that she was in some kind of sprawling, futuristic lab. She was lying on some kind of bench which felt oddly comfortable for something so solid. As she got up, she looked around these new surroundings; the lab was circular in shape with a huge pillar that was decorated with beautiful art, of some description, that had a modern looking aesthetic. There was a glowing white spiral staircase going up and around the pillar, leading to another floor of the lab, made of some kind of smooth, glowing metal fitting right in with the rest of the high-tech lab. She had been in a small alcove embedded into the pillar, and all around the room were workbenches that were filled with intriguing tech, the floor was made up of lots of black geometric shapes with white borders. There were also some floor to ceiling windows which showed a wonderful view of what could only be described as a *colossal* mine shaft with stretching stalagmites and stalactites of some form of glowing blue material, and all around this mineshaft was an underground network of trains, except the rails were bordered by odd looking panels that shone some form of light onto the trains as they passed.

In short, it was beautiful.

"Ungubani?" Catra span around as fast as she could to face the sudden sound, her tail straightened, her fur stood on end and her

claws shot out completely ready for any sudden attack! She then noticed that she was now facing a girl. She looked young, with skin like a Tiger's Eye gemstone. She had a kind face and was wearing, what looked like black leggings with a matching black sleeveless vest which was topped with a ruby red sleeveless jacket/waistcoat and around her neck was some form of string-based choker which was embezzled with pretty gemstones, and she was wearing a bracelet made of large, black beads. Her hair was long and black and braided as well as being in a ponytail which kind of reminded Catra of Adora. "Uyintoni?" she asked her, not that it made any sense to the Etherian at all. Catra deduced that, whoever this was, was speaking in a different language, she sighed in exasperation,

"Listen," she said with an air of malice, "I have *no idea* what you are saying, but I am trying my best to be a good person, so how about you let me out before things get ugly?"

"Oh, you only speak English?" the girl responded in surprise, "forgive me, I simply assumed you could understand any language seeing as you are an alien." Catra raised her eyebrow in confusion, so she *was* on a different planet?

"Where am I?" she asked the girl, hoping that she wouldn't have to fight her. She may enjoy the thrill of being in battle, but ever since she had turned over a new leaf, she tried her best to not cause fights with the inhabitants of other worlds.

"You are in Wakanda" the girl replied, "on a planet called Earth"

Earth? Catra hadn't heard of a planet like that before,

"Stupid name" she retorted before biting her tongue, "sorry, old habits" she then looked around at the lab once more, "what is this place? Who even are you?" the girl smiled in a kind and non-threatening way,

"My name is Shuri, a human, and as I told you, you are in Wakanda." She announced, "and who and what are you?"

“Um… my name is Catra” Catra stumbled, she still wasn’t used to others not knowing her, she had done *a lot* of evil things and a *lot* of people on Etheria *still* didn’t forgive her. “I’m an Etherian, from Etheria” Shuri held her hand out to her at this,

“it’s nice to meet you, Catra” every instinct in Catra’s body told her to run, or to flip this girl on her back and use her to get out of this place, but the way Shuri was acting wasn’t with any intent to harm her, so she reluctantly retracted her claws and took the girls hand and shook it,

“Nice to meet you too, Shuri”

The History of Wakanda

"What is this metal, Shuri?" Catra asked as she picked up a piece of that funny metal from one of the work desks, "I've never seen anything like it before"

"It's called Vibranium, the strongest thing in the universe" Shuri responded from another work desk, where she was working on two unusual devices, she put her tools down and approached the Etherian, "how it got here though, is quite the story…" she then proceeded to press one of the beads on her bracelet, causing one of the black tiles on the floor to rise up to form a table, and on closer inspection, Catra could see that it was actually not a tile, but black *sand* . Shuri pressed a few buttons on the side of the table, causing the sand to ripple,

"cool sand," Catra announced, but with a single smug smile from Shuri, Catra gave a deadpanned look, "This isn't sand, is it?"

"Nope, its Vibranium" Shuri responded, "would you like to hear how we Wakandans got it?" Catra thought for a moment, but her curiosity got the better of her, so she gave a small nod, and as she watched, the sand on the table began to float and form what looked like a planet, "my… my Baba used to tell me this story" Shuri sniffed sadly , making it clear to Catra that this girl must have lost, whoever a *Baba* is, "millions of years ago, a meteorite made of Vibranium, the strongest substance in the universe, struck the continent of Africa." At this point the sand formed a falling meteorite with a blue tinge to it, which plunged into a specific part of the planet, causing all the sand to return to the table, which then took the form of a landscape of trees, bushes and animals with a larger form of the meteorite slap-bang in the middle "it affected the plant life around it," Shuri continued as the blue from the meteorite spread across the landscape before Catra's eyes, "and when the time of man came, five tribes settled on it and called it Wakanda." At this, five hands formed from the sand and joined together in a pentagon shape before melting back to the table and replacing the scene with one Catra was *very*

familiar with… war! “the tribes lived in constant war with each other, until a warrior shaman received a vision from the Panther Goddess Bast,” at this, one warrior turned to face a giant panther with glowing blue eyes, he kneeled before it at this, “who lead him to the Heart-Shaped Herb” a bed of purple flowers then formed in front of him, he reached into one of the plants, pulled out its centre and swallowed it whole, causing the purple to flow though his body, “a plant that granted him super human strength, speed and instincts.” And as Catra watched in awe, the people around this warrior stopped fighting and made X’s with their arms whilst bowing their heads, and all the while, the warrior had a mask form around his face that looked like a panther, “the warrior became king and the first Black Panther, the protector of Wakanda.” Catra couldn’t help but feel a connection to this *Black Panther* guy, she did have similar powers to him. but then she noticed some of the people weren’t bowing and were walking towards some mountains in the distance, “four tribes agreed to live under the king’s rule” Shuri explained, “but the Jabari Tribe isolated themselves in the mountains.” As Catra watched, the sand quickly formed a great city around the area of Wakanda, “the Wakandans used Vibranium to develop technology more advanced than any other nation,” at this point, the sand shifted away from Wakanda and showed what was going on outside it; more wars, slavery, destruction and death, “but as Wakanda thrived, the world around it descended further into chaos,” the sand quickly formed Wakanda again, surrounded by thick jungles and those steep mountains, “to keep Vibranium safe, the Wakandans vowed to hide in plain sight, keeping the truth of their power from the outside world.” at this, some form of shield formed over the city and replaced the scene with more jungles that perfectly hid the whole thing from view, before it all dropped back to the table as still sand once again.

Catra was speechless at this revelation, and she started to wonder if there were places like that on Etheria, places that hid from the Horde and herself.

“I’m sorry,” Shuri said, “I didn’t mean to upset you” she didn’t even realise that she had been crying, she did that a lot lately. During their mission to bring magic back to the universe, Catra started having flashbacks to how evil she had been, how many friends she had made suffer. She didn’t want to tell Adora about it, so she had gone to Glimmer, who agreed to help her through something called “therapy” in which Glimmer would shut them both in the sleeping quarters and she would sit on a chair next to Catra who would lie on her bed and talk about what was bothering her. It was unusual, but it did work wonders to have someone who would listen to her problems. The only downside of this therapy was that Catra would usually end up crying as she remembered all the people that she hurt. So yeah, seeing all the wars that had played out on this planet already was enough to remind her of her past life.

“Oh! Pfft! Don’t worry about it” Catra stated whilst quickly wiping her tears away, “so, if there is a royal family in Wakanda, who’s the king now?” Again, this caused Shuri to drift off a bit with sadness plastered on her face,

“Our king, T’Chaka, was murdered a few days ago”

“Oh, I’m sorry” Catra announced in surprise,

“It’s ok, T’Chaka’s son will be crowned king in a few days as the queen is too old to rule on her own” Catra thought for a moment before asking,

“Did T’Chaka have a daughter?”

“Yes, his youngest child,” Shuri smiled as if she was hiding something, “is there something wrong with that?”

“Oh, no. There’s nothing wrong” Catra assured her, “it’s just highly likely I will meet her, it’s like a curse I have: wherever I go, I *always* end up next to a princess” Shuri chuckled at this,

“Well, I can’t guarantee you will meet the princess later, but I believe that in order for you to stay, you will need the Queen’s

permission”

“Of course,” Catra deadpanned whilst facepalming, why *wouldn’t* she have to encounter the royal family already?!

Catra decided as soon as she entered the throne room that she should just *expect* to be amazed by the staggering beauty of Wakandan architecture. The room was circular with a polished stone floor. It had golden pillars along the edge of the room and a ginormous window showing what Catra assumed was Wakanda’s capital city. In the middle of the room was a small square of cracked red clay, on which sat about eight chairs, all in a circle. One of which was larger than the others and had golden highlights. This must be the throne. And sitting next to the throne was an adult woman with slightly lighter skin than Shuri, who was wearing an odd black dress with a black shoulder mantle that could be compared to that of a peacock’s feathers. She was also wearing an odd black hat that looked a bit like an upside-down tutu. She was also wearing oddly shaped golden earrings. Catra could only assume this was the queen.

“Shuri?” the queen asked in a curious tone whilst eyeing Catra as if she was looking at a bomb, “Ngubani lo?”

“Le yiCatra ye-Etheria, kwaye ingumphambukeli” Shuri responded, Catra felt slightly awkward as she had no idea what they were saying, “ndimfumene engaphandle komda, akanayo enye indawo anokuya kuyo”, the queen glanced at Catra once more before saying,

“thetha”, the Etherian quickly turned towards Shuri hoping for some help,

“speak” she whispered. Ok, this was a crucial moment for Catra’s growth, she remembered what her friends had taught her about royal etiquette, first she bowed to the queen before saying,

“I am pleased to meet you, your… queenly…ness…” oh First-Ones! She was already struggling with how she was supposed to address royalty! “May I say that I’m sorry for your loss” she hoped this would be classed as being kind in Wakanda. “I am sure that your son will make a great king and if you were to give me sanctuary for the time being, I will be more than willing to protect your family if you wish” she didn’t know why she said that, but she meant it.

“Your name is Catra, right?” the Queen asked as the Etherian straightened up,

“Yes, your high… er… majesty… um… queen?” she *still* couldn’t remember what title to use!!! First-Ones, this was the worst first impression *ever* ! But the queen unexpectedly chuckled at this,

“just “your highness” will be fine” she told her, before turning to Shuri, “do you trust her, Shuri?” the girl smiled as she looked at Catra, and nodded,

“Yes mama” she told the queen,

“Then I guess it will be fine for you to stay, Catra” the queen nodded at the alien who’s tail flapped joyfully as she smiled,

“Thank you so much your highness…” she then realised what Shuri had said. Her eyes widened and her jaw dropped as she pointed at Shuri before pointing at the queen whilst stumbling over her words in shock “your…? You mean…? *YOU’RE* THE PRINCESS!?!” she then flumped to the ground with a mutter of, “I told you I was cursed”

The Nightmare

It had been a few days since Catra had arrived in Wakanda. It wasn't the first time she was trapped without any means of getting home, and to be honest, she found Wakanda to be rather relaxing. Shuri had already given her the brief rundown of life there, including what language they spoke. She had offered the Etherian to teach her to understand it, but Catra had declined, as she was more of the fighting type than the learning type.

During her first day in the palace, Shuri was giving Catra a tour through the palace when the Etherian had noticed a lot of bald women patrolling the halls whilst wearing odd looking red bodysuits with silver armour plating around their necks, shoulders, and wrists. They were also sporting coloured beads which were sown into the suits… oh, and they all carried large Vibranium spears! According to Shuri, these women were called Dora Milaje, who were basically the best warriors in the whole of Wakanda. To be honest, there seemed to be a Dora constantly following them throughout their tour.

"Oh," Shuri exclaimed on realising that Catra had noticed their tailer, "Catra, this is Ayo, second in command to the Dora Milaje," and then to the Dora, "and Ayo, I guess you know this is Catra of Etheria?" the Dora just nodded at this,

"Not very talkative, are you?" Catra remarked as she leant against the wall with her arms crossed, "why are you following us? Worried I might harm the princess?"

"yes" came the cold reply,

"Now that's…" Catra opened her mouth to retort, before realising something, "actually very fair"

At the end of the tour, Shuri offered Catra her own sleeping quarters, which was swiftly declined. She remembered having her own sleeping quarters in Bright Moon, and to put things plainly, *the bed itself was a NIGHTMARE!* She had ended up sleeping with a single blanket on the hard floor, though it didn't surprise her to hear Adora had that same situation on her first night there. So eventually it was decided that Catra would just sleep in the corner of Shuri's lab, and Catra was ok with admitting it was the closest thing to her time with the Horde that she had ever encountered. She ended up falling asleep to the sound of experiments and electronic fizzes and even a bit of metal grinding here and there, it was heaven!

"Hey Adora"

Catra looked down at her old friend, who was struggling to hold onto the goo/webbing left over from those spider robots. There was a seemingly endless chasm beneath her and Catra was holding the only thing that might help her survive if she fell: The Sword of Destiny, the one artefact that allowed Adora to transform into the all-powerful She-ra.

"Catra," Adora begged her oldest friend, "Help me, *please* " Catra looked down at the sword in her grasp and casually started talking without a sense of urgency or caring to her friend,

"This thing wouldn't work for me if I tried, would it? It only works for you. Then again, you're special. That's what Shadow Weaver always said." This clearly irritated Adora,

"Catra, what are you doing?" she asked in an angry tone, as Catra started pacing around,

"Ah, you know? It all makes sense now." She explained with resentment filling every word, "You've always been the one holding me back. You wanted me to think I needed you. You wanted me to feel weak. Every hero needs a sidekick, right?" the

room was starting to dissolve into blackness as Adora tried arguing against what Catra was saying,

“Catra, no, that's not how it was...” Catra laughed coldly at this,

“The sad thing is, I've spent all this time hoping you'd come back to the Horde, when really, you leaving was the best thing that ever happened to me.” She gave her old friend a deranged look and was delighted to see the terror in her eyes as she lowered the sword near the goo holding Adora up, “I am so much stronger than anyone ever thought.” She then cut a few strands of the goo, causing Adora to lose her grip with one hand, “I wonder what I could've been if I'd gotten rid of you sooner...” she then cut the last of the goo holding Adora up. Adora shrieked as she fell, luckily catching a rock-like handhold on the way down, halting her decent.

“I-I'm sorry!” she called up to the only person who could save her, “I never meant to make you feel like you were second best! Please don't do this!” but Catra just looked at the sword in her hands with an evil smirk on her face, before tossing it into the chasm, as the darkness crept closer and closer,

“Bye, Adora.” She called as she turned away, “I really am going to miss you.” Before walking away, leaving her friend to die,

“Catra! Catra NO!!!”

“ADORA!” Catra screamed as she sat up in a fright. As she looked around, she could see that she was still in Shuri’s lab, it was all a nightmare. There was no one around, so it must be incredibly late. She remembered that day, how open she was to letting Adora die, why she had forgiven her was still a mystery. Catra curled herself up into a ball and cried, she cried and cried and cried until she was just left as a tear-soaked, whimpering mess on the floor.

Unbeknownst to the depressed Etherian, she *was* in fact being watched. Shuri had been watching the CCTV in her lab for the last hour or so from the comfort of her own room, she had seen Catra thrashing around in her sleep before she woke up with a start screaming, "ADORA!!!". Shuri knew better than to pry, but she could tell that her guest was lost and broken, so in a split second she made up her mind. She quickly pulled on a dressing gown and rushed out of her room. She made a beeline to her lab, quickly unlocked the door and sped down the spiral to Catra. She knew that Catra might retaliate and attack her, but she didn't care, all she cared about was that her friend was hurting, and she wanted her to know that she wasn't alone.

"Catra?" she made herself known, as she approached the Etherian, before wrapping her arms around her shaking form.

In any normal situation, Catra would have hissed at the girl, or slashed her with her claws, anything to get her to go away, but she was all out of energy from crying, so she just sat there, sobbing in her newest friend's embrace.

Catra never forgot how kind Shuri had been to her that night. But it was the fact that girl never asked any questions about her problems and instead let the Etherian decide whether to tell her what was troubling her, that was what warmed Catra's heart. Shuri was a wonderful friend, and Catra was glad that of all people who could have found her, it was Shuri.

The Prince Returns

After spending a few days in Wakanda, Catra was told some interesting news.

She was in the middle of showing Shuri her skills, this was by sparing against Ayo, and to say Shuri was impressed would be an understatement. They had agreed to go without weapons (or in Catra's case, claws) and so, as Ayo lunged at the Etherian, Catra didn't even bother taking her hands out of her pockets as she nimbly dodged every blow. And even when Ayo charged at her from behind, Catra just jumped, landed on the Dora's shoulder, which in turn knocked her down whilst at the same time, Catra leaped off and landed behind her, with her hands still in her pockets and a smug smirk on her face. As Ayo quickly got back to her feet, Catra un-pocketed her hands and raised her fists. As the Dora charged forward, Catra cartwheeled over her before landing a reverse roundhouse kick to her opponent's back, but Ayo quickly recovered from the blow, and now they were in close quarters, Catra had to block every blow the Dora threw at her. Eventually though, Catra was able to duck under one of Ayo's blows, get behind her once again, and pull her opponent's arms behind her back before sweeping Ayo's legs out from underneath her, and pinning her to the ground.

"I win" Catra announced before standing up and brushing herself down. She then held her hand out to Ayo who graciously took it and let the Etherian help her up.

"That was incredible!" Shuri exclaimed in awe as Catra and Ayo shook hands, "Catra, your abilities seem incredibly close to those of the Black Panther himself! With a bit of training, you could be able to *best* him in combat"

"Then I better not train that much, Princess" Catra retorted, the less chance she has against a figure of authority, the less likely

she would try to take control again.

Catra sometimes called Shuri "Princess", just like she did with any princess she met, but she was glad that Shuri didn't mind. At that moment, those black beads around Shuri's wrist gave a technological chime. Shuri held out her hand with her palm facing up and flicked one of these beads to the centre of her hand. This bead produced a holographic projection of the Queen herself,

"Shuri, I hope you are ready for T'Challa's coronation tomorrow" the Queen announced, causing Shuri to roll her eyes,

" *Yes, mama* ", she said in an exasperated tone. The Queen had been going on about this over the last few days, and was even expecting Catra to go, which was made easier when Shuri messaged her brother to let him know about Wakanda's new resident Etherian. Apparently, he was concerned at first, but Shuri was able to convince him that Catra meant no harm.

The only thing that worried Catra was what she was supposed to wear, as she had been wearing her normal attire since she arrived, but Ayo had agreed to lend her some traditional clothing just for the occasion. So as the big day dawned, before Catra was to try on her costume, she was to meet the soon to be king as he returned to Wakanda. So, as the sun rose; she, Shuri, the queen, and Ayo were waiting patiently outside the palace, and Catra's eyes widened as she beheld an amazing sight! There was a metallic (probably vibranium) vehicle of some description flying towards them which bared some resemblance to Darla (Mara's spaceship) just without the side panels and far less polygonal. As it landed, a ramp lowered and down stepped three individuals; the first was a man with very short black hair and a small black beard who was wearing an odd black suit with silver trimmings and a silver claw necklace, he was obviously T'Challa. The next person was a woman wearing a turquoise scarf around her head, a green

tunic top with 3/4 length sleeves and ripped dark green jeans as well as a green and white necklace around her neck, and the last was obviously Okoye, as she was wearing a similar uniform to the other Dora Milaje, except instead of silver armour plating, hers was golden. The other Dora Milaje that were around the landing zone, Ayo included, all simultaneously crossed their arms in an x before breaking the shape in some form of salute. As the trio approached them, the unknown woman curtsied to the Queen and Shuri,

“Queen Mother… princess… my comfort for your loss” she said kindly with a hint of sadness.

“Thank you, Nakia,” the Queen responded, “it is so good to have you back with us”

“Take her to the River Province to prepare her for the ceremony” Okoye ordered Ayo,

“Yes general” she responded whilst tapping her left fist on her right shoulder in another form of salute, before nodding to the woman called Nakia before leading her away. Once they were gone, Shuri smirked before saying,

“Did he freeze?” and Okoye smiled back whilst responding,

“Like an antelope in headlights” causing the young princess to chuckle, and Catra just shrugged, guessing this was some form of an inside-joke,

“Are you finished?” T’Challa asked with a small smirk as well, and on this, Okoye banged her spear on the ground twice, and all the surrounding Dora’s marched away. T’Challa then turned to face the Etherian, “so, I guess you must be the Catra Shuri told me about?” Catra nodded and bowed grandly, but Shuri tapped her on the shoulder with the back of her hand whilst shaking her head, “ahh, we don’t do that here" T’Challa explained as Catra straightened up, “how are you enjoying Wakanda?”

“It is incredibly beautiful, Mr Soon-to-be-King” she smirked, “Shuri has made me feel most welcome”

“Well, if you call Shuri by her name, I guess you can just call me T’Challa” he responded, before turning to Shuri with a grin “speaking of, I’m so surprised my little sister came to see me off before our big day,”

“You wish,” Shuri retorted, “I’m here for the EMP beads, I’ve developed an update” this seemed to take T’Challa by surprise,

“Update?” he asked, questioningly, “no, it worked perfectly” Shuri sighed on hearing this,

“How many times to I have to teach you, just because something works, doesn't mean that it cannot be improved.” Catra’s smirk widened into a grin on witnessing this conversation,

“ *You* are teaching me?” T’Challa tutted before handing her some more beads like the ones on her bracelet, “What do you know?”

“More than you” Shuri retorted before walking away,

“I cannot wait to see what kind of *update* you make to your ceremonial outfit.” T’Challa called out to her, and in response, she gave him the middle finger without even turning around, Catra gasped at this,

“You *rebel* !” she exclaimed as she followed her friend, but this tipped off the Queen to the action,

“ *Shuri* !” she called to the departing princess, who rapidly dropped her hand with a quick

“Sorry mother!”

Back in Shuri’s lab, Catra took back all the thanks she gave to Ayo, as the “ceremonial outfit” she was expected to wear was *definitely* not her style! As she looked in the mirror, she cringed. She was

wearing; something Shuri called a strapless Bandeau top and absolutely *nothing* else on her top half, which made her whole body feel vulnerable. Plain, black, high-waist, synthetic leggings with an orangey-red binding at the top which she had to admit she did like. She had been given some sandals and something called neck-rings, but the sandals were a no go as Catra never wore anything over her feet if she had the choice, and the neck-rings rubbed against the scar on the back of her neck and brought back some unpleasant memories. But she was glad that her hair didn't need altering, as Adora and her other Etherian friends figured out the hard way, *Catra never brushes her hair* !

"ta-da!" Catra spun around to see Shuri wearing a costume that was *way* better than hers. It consisted of a short black skirt and some form of corset with red and white trimmings as well as loops of colourful beads along her shoulders, middle and her neck, but the thing that made Catra chuckle was that she was wearing a headdress that went over her face that strapped some form of animal jawbone to the bottoms of her cheeks.

"don't laugh" she said whilst trying her best not to join in, as they both clearly found these costumes hilarious, "that suits you, you know?" she added, but Catra shook her head,

"As soon as I get to cover up, I will be happy." She pointed out, before asking, "so Shuri, what happens in this ceremony anyway?"

"Well," the princess started, "T'Challa will have his powers taken away to start with, and then the four tribes will choose whether they wish to put forward a warrior to fight for the throne and title of Black Panther, and for someone to win, their opponent has to yield, or be killed." Catra was gobsmacked,

"So let me get this straight: your king dies, so you put his heir, who could still be grieving, in a massive fight to earn the right to take over which, in doing so, could also get him *killed* ?!?"

“yes” Shuri replied without seeing anything wrong, causing Catra to smile broadly,

“And I thought I couldn’t like this place any more than I did this morning”

The Ceremony Begins

"Ohhhhgh, First Ones" Catra groaned. She couldn't believe this was happening, of all the ways they could get to the location of the fight, it was by *boat* ! She was grasping the edge of the boat she was on for some form of stability, but this was to little avail for nothing would stop the boat from bobbing up and down on the river. Catra glanced behind her at the festivities; on each boat, drummers were drumming to the same beat, and everyone was dancing and enjoying themselves whilst they travelled to the location of T'Challa's ceremony. As Catra saw Shuri dancing with her mother, she kind of wished that she *herself* had had that sort of fun with a parental figure, but she only got electrical torture from her mother figure before she died, Catra then suddenly retched before sticking her head over the edge of the boat and vomiting.

Shuri broke away from her mother as she noticed Catra wasn't having such a good time, her face had turned a bit green, and she was clearly struggling to stay standing.

"Are you ok, Catra?" she asked the Etherian, who just groaned in response,

"Just *peachy* " she then retched again before wiping her mouth and turning to her friend, "you could have mentioned we would be traveling by *boat* " she complained, Causing Shuri to chuckle,

"I guess you don't like water that much?" she asked, and the glare that Catra shot back at her said it all, "well don't worry, we will be there soon…"

"PHAMBILI!!!" Okoye shouted from her own boat with the rest of the Dora Milaje, who echoed her call before they all slammed their spears to the deck of their boat. And as she watched, Catra saw the water ahead of them start draining away from the edge a waterfall and some form of hidden alcove underneath was

revealed. At this point the boats docked at both river edges, and Catra didn’t even wait for a ramp to drop, she just flung herself over the edge and welcomed the earth as an old friend. when the Queen gave a puzzled look to Shuri, the princess whispered,

“uyawacaphukela amanzi” before they both disembarked the boat and led Catra through a network of tunnels to the location of the ceremony: the Warrior Falls.

Catra, Shuri and the Queen were all right at the edge of a pool of ankle-deep water with the Dora Milaje behind them, and behind them seemed to be the whole country of Wakanda, all wearing different colours and costumes. As they watched, the ship from earlier appeared at the edge of the falls and hovered there before letting its ramp down into the pool. At this point, everyone there started chanting something that sounded like,

“Ngu T'Challa Lo” in some form of melodic rhythm, and down from the ramp stepped T’Challa, who was now only wearing dark purple trunks and black war paint on his face and leopard body paint on chest. He was holding a short Vibranium spear in his right hand and a shield in his left. The ship then retracted the ramp and flew away leaving T’Challa in the middle of this pool with a bald man with black face paint on, who was wearing a regal looking purple robe that dragged in the water, he was also carrying what looked like an older version of the Vibranium spears, as its pole was made of wood instead of metal. The audience stopped chanting and the man in purple announced to them, in English whilst rolling his r’s,

“I, Zuri… son of Badu… give to you… Prince T’Challa… the Black Panther!” on this, the audience cheered as T’Challa waved his chosen weapons above his head before dropping to one knee and lowered the weapons to his sides. In response, Catra noticed the audience do that X salute again, and decided to try doing it herself by crossing her left arm over her right, Shuri clearly noticed this and hissed at her,

“Right over left” Catra was quick to fix this error but was still a tiny bit embarrassed. By now, the man called Zuri had handed a woman his spear and had in turn taken a small bowl from her. He raised this bowl to the audience before announcing once more,

“The prince… will now have… the strength of the Black Panther… stripped away.” He then proceeded to approach T’Challa who allowed him to pore whatever was in the bowl down his throat, and instantly the prince started reacting violently to the effects of this liquid, choking on it as he spasmed with his veins expanding and his muscles contracting as whatever that liquid was did its job. Meanwhile, the drummers had started up again in a smooth beat and Catra noticed, in confusion, that everyone had once again crossed their arms and were bouncing their arms to the drumbeat.

After a few seconds of clear agony, T’Challa took a few deep breaths as his body stopped spasming before getting back to his feet

“Damaku” Zuri announced

“Damaku” the audience echoed, and on seeing Catra’s confused expression, Shuri quickly whispered,

“Praise the ancestors” to her as a translation, which the Etherian gave a small smile and a smaller nod to her friend.

“Victory… in ritual combat…” Zuri explained to the audience, “comes by *yield* or *death* . If any tribe wishes to put forth a warrior… I now offer… a path… to the throne.” At this point, someone shouted,

“yyuuu!” which was echoed by the tribe around the shouter, it was the tribe Shuri had explained to be the Merchant Tribe. The warrior who had drawn attention to them was dressed in white robes and a large blue turban and face scarf. He was standing

next to an old lady wearing flowing blue robes and large earrings who was supporting herself on a cane, who announced,

"The Merchant Tribe… will not challenge today"

"HAIIY!" shouted a man wearing some form of blue blanket who, Shuri had told Catra, was a family friend called W'Kabi and that he was a member of the Border Tribe. The rest of his tribe echoed the shout before the man standing next to W'Kabi, who was covered from head to toe in blankets, announced,

"The Border Tribe will not challenge today"

"Yibambe!" Nakia shouted from the River Tribe area, Catra had seen her ceremonial outfit on the boat ride and it made the Etherian glad that she wasn't wearing that, as all I'm saying is that it seemed more *way* more uncomfortable than the costume she was currently wearing. Her tribespeople echoed her call before a man wearing a flowing green shoulder sash with flared sleeves, some form of horned woollen hat, who also had a lip plate and ear gauges, announced,

"The River Tribe will not challenge today" and the same could be said for the red and orange cladded Mining Tribe, and Catra was mildly concerned that there would be no fighting at all.

Zuri stepped forward once again, advancing on the royal family, making Catra nervous. Had she been brought here as a warrior if no one else would fight?! But her fears were dismissed once Zuri started announcing once again,

"Is there any member of a royal blood… who wishes to challenge… for the throne?" he gestured to T'Challa at this, and to everyone's immense surprise, *Shuri* raised her hand. Catra eyed her curiously, she *clearly* wasn't a fighter, she was *definitely* more of a techy person! But once again, Catra needn't have worried,

“This corset is really uncomfortable,” Shuri announced plainly, before smirking and facing the audience above her, “so could we all just wrap it up and go home?” whilst clapping her hands with the last two words, receiving a pinch from the queen, moans from the adults and giggles from the children for her troubles. Catra sniggered at this and was happy to see that T’Challa too was smirking whilst shaking his head in disbelief.

The Jabari Challenge

“BAFA! YE OOH OOH! BAFA! YE OOH OOH! BAFA! YE OOH OOH!” Catra jerked to face the direction of this sudden chant that echoed across the Warrior Falls. The rest of Wakanda also turned to face the sound, which was coming from one of the cave entrances that was to the far left of the royal family. Out of the cave emerged a line of burly men wearing nothing, but some form skirts made of a combination of grass and fabric, the rest of their bodies were covered in in streaks of white war paint. They were incredibly intimidating and Catra counted about 6 of them holding wooden spears as they exited the cave, followed by a man wearing a wooden mask that resembled that of a gorilla, it even had sharp teeth that stuck out where the man’s mouth was. This man had a regal look about him, but it was the sort of regal that Catra got whenever she was in the presence of the old Hordak, and she knew this man was bad news. He was also holding a staff that had an end like a club, with its base sharpened to a point. This man approached T’Challa and Zuri whilst the others stuck to the edge of the pool.

“Are they Jabari?” Catra heard Shuri whisper to the queen,

“yes” came the nervous reply, making Catra feel on edge as her fight-or-flight instincts started kicking in. the man in the mask was now right in front of T’Challa, and at this point he removed his mask, not that it helped Catra understand who this was she was looking at.

“M'Baku,” Zuri confronted the man, “what are you doing here?”

“Its challenge day” he replied before turning towards the audience and shouting, “we have watched and listened from the mountains!” He then started advancing on the royal family, “we have watched with *disgust* as your technological advancements have been overseen by a *CHILD* !!!” he then pointed the club end of his staff at Shuri in a threatening manner! The Dora Milaje surrounding them were quick to react by pointing their spears at

the man, and at the same time, Catra protectively grabbed Shuri's shoulder with her left hand and pulled the girl behind her whilst she extended the claws of her right hand, ready to defend her friend,

"Just try it, Monkey-Boy" she hissed with her hackles raised as she glared at the Jabari man, to which he just glared back and backed away, turning back to T'Challa, and advancing on him whilst continuing his monologue,

"Who scoffs at tradition! And now you want to hand the nation over to this prince who could not keep his own father safe!" Catra now wished he had tried attacking Shuri, as she would be glad to take this guy down after he played that card! Even she had never stooped that low! "Mmm? We will not have it." He said before shouting, "I SAID, "WE WILL NOT HAVE IT" OH! I, M'Baku, leader of the Jabari wish to…" but before he could finish, T'Challa calmly announced,

"I accept your challenge, M'Baku."

"Glory to Hanuman" the Jabari leader responded with a grin.

Catra watched in awe as the Wakandan leaders prepared for this ceremonial battle. T'Challa was brought a similar mask to M'Baku's, except his was a black, panther head shape. Zuri slotted the mask over the prince's head whilst M'Baku put his own back on. He then raised his fist and shouted,

"Jabari! ABIYAA!" and in response, the Jabari warriors formed a semicircle around them and in front of the crowd, probably to keep the fight away from the spectators. T'Challa repeated the notion by raising his fist and shouting,

"Dora Milaje! PHAMBILI!!!" Okoye, in response, banged her staff twice against the rocky ground, and six of the seven Dora stationed behind the royal family marched into the pool, joining the six Jabari warriors and completing a border of spear armed

warriors that would keep the battle away from the audience. Once everyone was ready, Zuri shouted,

"Let the challenge… begin!!!" before banging his staff once in the pool before quickly stepping to the side.

Catra's Heterochromatic eyes widened as she watched the two opponents; T'Challa prowled forward, clearly waiting for M'Baku to make the first move. He didn't have to wait long, as the Jabari leader charged forward with a yell and swung his club-staff-thing at the prince! T'Challa blocked the first blow with his shield, and dodged the next two with impressive reflexes, he then blocked the next two swings with the shield before parrying another blow with his spear. M'Baku then swung his weapon to T'Challa's side, which was once again blocked by the shield, but this blow had enough force to knock the prince onto his back!

"STAND UP!" M'Baku yelled at the prince, who was quick to get back to his feet before taking a swing at the man with his spear before landing a fierce kick to his gut! This may have knocked the Jabari leader down, but he got up just as quickly as T'Challa had, "AARRGGH!!! COME!" he screamed in anger, and Catra closed her eyes and shook her head as T'Challa instantly charged forward. She knew from experience that if someone told her to charge at them during a battle, it was because they *wanted* her to charge forward! She knew M'Baku had a plan, and half of her couldn't wait to see it.

M'Baku greeted the prince with a volley of swings from his weapon, some of which were blocked by T'Challa's shield, some of which T'Challa ducked under, but one blow got through his defence, and sent the prince into a spin before crashing into the water with his mask and weapons flying out of reach! Catra tutted at this whilst shaking her head,

“shouldn’t have done what his enemy wanted” she muttered as the prince got back to his feet, now unarmed. T’Challa raised his fists whilst M’Baku laughed,

“Where is your god now?!?” he asked rhetorically before lunging at T’Challa with the sharpened end of his weapon! T’Challa dodged the blow, caught hold of the weapon as it passed over his Shoulder, and quickly used his momentum to flip over and deliver a roundhouse kick to the man’s head! But seeing as M’Baku still had his face protection, he was quick to shrug off the blow before swinging the club end of his weapon at T’Challa, who dodged and delivered a few strong punches to M’Baku’s stomach and head, knocking the Jabari leader to the ground!

M’Baku quickly got to his feet, lunged at his opponent once which T’Challa dodged, but the Jabari leader then quickly closed the gap between him and the prince and used his weapon to hold him in a bear hug! Lifting the prince off his feet! As T’Challa struggled, M’Baku lifted him higher and Catra cringed as he delivered multiple crushing headbutts to the prince!

“HAHAHA!” M’Baku laughed, “No powers!” *HEADBUTT* “No claws!” *HEADBUTT* “No special suit, oh! Just a boy, not fit to lead!” those teeth on the mask had given T’Challa large gashes on his face and he seemed on the verge of losing consciousness, that is… until the queen called out to him!

“SHOW HIM WHO YOU ARE!” she yelled, and Catra’s eyes widened as T’Challa lifted his head to face M’Baku and delivered a monster of a blow onto his head, creating a crack in his mask! T’Challa repeated the blow once more before ramming M’Baku’s face with his shoulder! This broke him out of the bear hug and also shattered the Jabari leader’s mask! Now M’Baku had similar gashes to his face, and as he whipped his face and saw the blood, he roared in anger before plunging the sharp end of his weapon into T’Challa’s shoulder! Catra and many of the other Wakandans gasped at this turn of events as T’Challa screamed in pain and

blood flowed from the wound! And M'Baku didn't stop there! He kept pushing the weapon further in as T'Challa attempted to pull it out! In defiance to the pain, T'Challa yelled,

"I am Prince T'Challa! Son of King T'Chaka!"

"You can do this, T'Challa!" Shuri called out, and even Catra couldn't help but also call out,

"don't let him win!!" and with one final burst of strength, T'Challa ripped the weapon out of his shoulder, caught it as M'Baku attempted to impale him in the stomach, and knocked it out of his hands before Kicking the Jabari leader to the ground with a splash! Before he could recover, T'Challa quickly rolled forward and caught M'Baku in a chokehold between his thighs and dragged him to the edge of the waterfall! The audience started chanting T'Challa's name and Catra assumed he would throw the Jabari leader over the edge to claim victory, but she was surprised to hear the prince shout out,

"Yield! Don't make me kill you!" her respect for the Wakandan prince sored at this!

"I would rather die!" she could hear M'Baku scream in response, and after a few heart stopping moments, T'Challa tried again,

"You have fought with honour! Now yield! Your people need you!" and when M'Baku didn't respond, T'Challa yelled "YIELD MAN!" and on this… M'Baku tapped out, and T'Challa instantly released him and the whole audience to erupted into cheers!

T'Challa raised his fist into the air in victory as the Jabari helped their leader to his feet. And as he staggered forward, Catra couldn't help herself and started applauding, hoping that it was ok to do that, and seeing as Shuri didn't stop her, she assumed it was ok. Zuri then stepped forward, holding some form of ceremonial tooth necklace,

“I now present to you! *King* T’Challa!” he then proceeded to place the necklace around the newly crowned king’s neck, “the Black Panther!” they then hugged each other whilst the Dora Milaje started dancing in victory. As they separated, T’Challa looked at his people and smiled warmly, before crossing his arms and shouting,

“WAKANDA FOREVER!” and everyone, (but the Jabari), repeated the action, and echoed his shout,

“WAKANDA FOREVER!”, Catra smiled as she crossed her own arms and said,

“Wakanda forever” and as she smiled, Shuri tapped her on the shoulder before whispering,

“Right over left” with a chuckle.

The Memories

Back in Shuri's Lab, Catra had finally changed out of her ceremonial costume and was now back to wearing her old suit, and as she had pulled it on, she realised it was soon going to need fixing or replacing as it had numerous rips and tears all over it.

She leaned against the window and watched the trains moving Vibranium to who-knows-where and enjoyed the quiet hum of the lab machines. It was very peaceful and partially reminded her of home.

"Thank you"

Catra turned to face the voice and saw Shuri who had obviously just changed out of her own ceremonial outfit. She was now wearing a cropped raglan-sleeve blouse with a heather grey body, pink sleeves, and matching cape as well as a bluey-grey skirt and silver shoes.

"What are you thanking me for?" Catra asked the Wakandan princess, "I didn't do anything"

"For defending me, Catra" Shuri explained with a smile, "you know? When M'Baku was threatening me?" the Etherian smiled proudly as the memory came back.

"Yeah, well I…" she stopped herself mid-sentence, and sighed sadly, "I'm not the only one who defended you, you should really be thanking the Dora Milaje" she refused to take all the credit, that sort of thing always ended badly for her.

"Well, it is their *job* to protect me," Shuri pointed out as she joined her by the window, "I don't even know all of them that well, it's only Ayo and Okoye who really got to know me personally. But *you* defended me and even threatened M'Baku back with no

reason to do so, so thank you Catra" before wrapping her up in an embrace. This made the Etherian smile, in the past she would have struggled out of the hug and would feel incredibly uncomfortable being touched like that but, over time, she started enjoying the feeling of being held by people who cared for her.

"you're welcome, Shuri" she whispered as she returned the embrace.

Catra had something stuck on her mind for the past hour; she knew, as she used to be a soldier, that the injuries that T'Challa had received could be serious and could even affect him even after they healed.

"Will your brother be, ok?" she asked without turning away from the view outside the lab. Shuri, who had been tinkering with the beads T'Challa had given her earlier, stopped working for a second and lifted her head to face her guest,

"What do you mean?" she asked which resulted in the Etherian finally turning away from the window and look at her with concern

"Those were some serious injuries he received in that battle"

"Oh, don't worry about it, Catra" Shuri explained, "now that T'Challa's powers have been restored through the consumption of the Heart Shaped Herb, all his injuries he sustained will have healed as if they never even happened at all" and all of a sudden, Shuri yawned loudly, which started Catra off who yawned, baring her fangs whilst giving a stretch. Shuri chuckled at her friend's cat-like yawn, before checking her bracelet and sighing at the time, "it's getting late, we should turn in for the night." She then stood up and headed up the stairs and to the exit.

Just before she exited the lab, she looked back down at Catra, who hadn't moved from her place at the window, something was

clearly on the Etherian's mind, but Shuri had made up her mind a good while ago that she would let Catra tell her what was bothering her in her own time, "good night Catra!" she called before leaving the room.

As Shuri left, the lights dimmed and Catra immediately let the flood-gates open. She fell to her knees and sobbed; she didn't deserve this kindness! She had committed numerous crimes and had betrayed every person she cared about! She knew that if she was in T'Challa's position at the end of that fight, she would have probably let M'Baku fall to his death! But no! T'Challa was more honourable than she ever would be! She crawled over to her corner and curled up in her blanket, still sniffling.

She was desperate! She just *had* to get Glimmer away from this ship! The Prime clones holding her pulled her away from the teleport console and she saw the princess watching in terror from behind the shields, if she didn't activate the teleport soon, neither of them would get out, and Adora would try to save Glimmer and fall right into Prime's trap!

"Catra, I don't understand," her childhood friends voice came through the communicator, "why are you…?" but she couldn't keep this up and she still had one thing to say to the only ray of sunshine she had in her dark life,

"JUST LISTEN!" she screamed in desperation and tears in her eyes as the clones slammed her against the wall and she struggled in their grasp, "Adora! I'M SORRY! FOR EVERYTHING!!!" and with one final burst of strength she broke free from the clones and activated the teleport. But even though she knocked one clone down, three more piled onto her, pinning her to the floor. But they were too late, Glimmer was gone. Two of the clones restrained her, though there was no need, she had exhausted all her strength. They took her before Horde Prime and pushed her down to her knees. She immediately looked at the ground, refusing to

give the dictator the light of day, but without a sound, he simply pushed her head back up with his boot under her chin.

"The Etherian ship has changed course," he declared, as he stood up, "but your treachery will not save them," and she could suddenly hear the clones around them chanting

"Prime casts out all shadows" over and over, louder and louder.

"There is no darkness that my light cannot pierce, no distance that my hand cannot reach." She glanced behind her and saw the glowing green eyes of hundreds of clones all looking at her from the shadows, "they will not be able to hide from me forever!" Prime then glared down at her, "you were beloved in my sight, and this is how you repay me. She then laughed at the tyrant,

"What did you expect?" she asked, "after all, us *Etherians* are *so very emotional* . It doesn't matter what you do to me. Glimmer is gone and you will never get your hands on Adora," but her confidence was crushed with what prime said next,

"oh, my child, you're wrong. Everyone has a place in my empire." He then grabbed her chin, "you will be of use to me yet"

"AGH! *NOO!!!* " Catra screamed as her eyes snapped open, she was back in Shuri's Lab, it was all a dream, but she knew that that had already happened. She was visibly shaking, remembering that day as the day she did the first good thing in her life, and she was willing to welcome death as her punishment… but she was given a fate *much* worse. She gripped her hair in her hands as she curled herself into a ball, still trembling from reliving the moment when she was about to lose her freedom, and even after doing the right thing, she still lost everything!

"it's my destiny to lose, no matter what I try, I will always lose!" she sobbed, not realising that she was being watched from above.

Shuri felt bad for spying on Catra, but she had had Griot (her Lab's AI) notify her if the Etherian had any more… *incidents* . So here she was sitting on the edge of her bed, watching and listening as Catra sobbed. Shuri frowned,

"What is wrong with her?" she asked herself, "I did a full scan of her when she arrived, and there was nothing wrong" she then realised that Catra had hinted multiple times that she had had a bad past, she decided to act on this and ask Catra to tell her about her past if this situation happened again. She then pulled on her dressing gown and rushed back to her lab to comfort the broken Etherian.

The Inventions of Shuri

The next morning, Catra was surprised to wake up and see Shuri slumped over one of her workbenches nearby, she was still in her dressing gown and Catra could just about hear her friend snoring lightly. The thing that confused her was that Catra could distinctly remember Shuri leaving the lab for the night, so why was she here? It then all came flooding back to her, she had had another panic attack last night, and Shuri had once again come to her rescue and comforted her until she had fallen asleep, she must have stayed in the lab just in case another incident happened. Catra felt guilty about this, the fact that she was disturbing her friend with her troubles was slightly upsetting for her. She got to her feet and gently shook her friend's shoulder, which caused the Wakandan princess to stir, and as her eyes opened, she smiled at Catra,

"Good morning, Catra" she said as she stretched her arms over her head and stood up with a yawn, once again causing Catra to give a cat-like yawn, which once again caused Shuri to chuckle, "how was your night?"

"Better than it was," the Etherian admitted, "thank you,"

"don't mention it," Shuri brushed the thanks away, "you're my friend, so I will help you if I can."

After they had gotten up and cleaned up for the day, Shuri decided to teach Catra about some of the basic tech in her lab, mainly the HID (Holographic Image Designer) and Catra was a natural. Shuri had given her a bracelet similar to her own, but apparently the beads were actually devices called Kimoyo Beads, which had many functions, but the ones on her bracelet were all the same in order for Catra to actually use the HID. Apparently, the beads would track her movements and allow her to interact with her holographic creation. She was enjoying this, as she could simulate all forms of matter the Wakandans had to offer and

create her own thing. Not that this thing would be created, it was just a bit of fun after all, but Catra decided to start with something classical, as well as simple. So, after a few hours of work, Shuri came over to see what she had made and was surprised to see a holographic image of some form of headdress; it was the sort that masked the cheeks before ending with a point towards where the wearer's nose would be. It was also shaped so that the top featured two points alongside two triangular indents that gave it a feline sense. She could also see that Catra had decided to use Vibranium as the material used for its makeup. In short, it was incredible.

"That looks good Catra" Shuri announced, "where did you get the inspiration for it?"

"Oh, it's just a remake of my old headdress" the Etherian explained as she saved her work, "me and Adora found the original in…" but she never got to finish that sentence, as alarms started chiming around the lab!

"Griot!" Shuri called out to her AI, "what's happening?" and throughout the lab, a male, robotic voice stated a single phrase,

"Ulysses Klaue is back!"

"So, what's the issue with this Klaue guy?" Catra asked completely out of the loop as Shuri seemed to work double time on all her devices that were scattered on different workbenches in the lab, all the while the other Wakandans in there were trying to do their work faster too, whoever this guy was, Catra deduced at the least that he was *bad news* .

"Klaue is an enemy of Wakanda." Shuri announced as she fiddled with something that looked like a pair of insoles, "24 years ago, Klaue managed to sneak into Wakanda, stole a quarter ton of Vibranium, and then detonated a bomb at the Border in order to escape!" Catra gasped at this, she knew that the Border Tribe lived at the Border! "Many people died that day, and my Baba's

greatest regret was that he never caught him. I had a feeling that he had resurfaced last year, as the Avengers were fighting against an AI called Ultron, who managed to create a special robotic body using Vibranium, it was lucky that the Avengers got the body before Ultron could transfer his consciousness into it, or the world could have been destroyed." Catra had already been told about the so-called "Earth's Mightiest Heroes" but decided to not further question this incident,

"So, how do we know this is him?" the Etherian asked, resulting in Shuri stopping her work and activating hologram projector, which showed a rusted pickaxe with a long handle,

"because this misidentified Vibranium tool was stolen from the Museum of Great Britain yesterday, and Klaue has been discovered to want to sell the Vibranium part to an unidentified American buyer in South Korea tomorrow night" she then deactivated the hologram and went back to work, but not before stating, "T'Challa has also already decreed that he will go on a mission to capture Klaue on the night of the exchange, so we need to finish this equipment before he arrives"

It was a few hours later when the new king entered the lab, with Shuri and Catra waiting by the entrance for him. as he arrived, the Dora Milaje behind him took their positions on either end of the corridor and gave him the Wakandan salute, which he lightly repeated in response as he approached his sister and her Etherian guest.

"My king" Shuri announced grandly with a bow, making T'Challa chuckle,

"Stop it, stop it" he smirked as Shuri too started giggling, Catra then bared witness to the two siblings performing a secret handshake that ended with them both doing the Wakandan salute.

“Your high… king… ness?” Catra stumbled over her words again, before attempting the salute again, resulting in T’Challa chuckling again,

“It’s right over left” he stated with a wide smile, making the Etherian mentally facepalm, one day she would get it. They then started walking down the spiral to the main floor of the lab,

“I’ve already sent a car ahead to Busan for you,” Shuri told her brother before asking, “who are you taking with you to Korea?”

“Okoye…” before giving his sister a sideways glance with a small grin, “and Nakia as well” this made Shuri stop and look at him in disbelief as he continued down the spiral,

“You sure it’s a good idea to take your *ex* on a mission?” she asked, making Catra’s eyes widen in surprise, Nakia was T’Challa’s *ex* ? That would explain the whole *freezing* joke the other day, she too had frozen a few times on seeing Adora after a long time during her Horde days.

“Yes,” T’Challa nodded, “we’ll be fine. Besides, you’ll be on call should we need backup.” Making Shuri silently fist pump the air,

“Actually, T’Challa?” Catra asked the king as they reached the main floor of the lab, “I would like to volunteer for this mission,”

“Really?” T’Challa asked with a raised eyebrow, “why?”

“I want to prove my worth to Wakanda, as thanks for taking me in” the Etherian explained with a hopeful look on her face. The king thought for a minute, before smiling,

“Ok, you can come”

“Yes!” she pumped the air in a similar fashion to Shuri as they followed the lab’s owner around the various worktops.

“I have great things to show you, brother” she announced before gesturing to a small, open, ovel shaped, silver box with five

translucent ovel shaped devices inside, "here are your communication devices for Korea" Shuri stated as T'Challa closed the box and pocketed it "Unlimited range, also equipped with audio surveillance system." She then led them to another table with Kimoyo Beads and some small avocado shaped devices with flat, silver bases, "check these out" she told them as she picked one of these devices up, "remote access Kimoyo Beads, updated to interface directly with my sand table" T'Challa nodded at this and then walked over to the next table and saw the insole like devices,

"And what are these?" he asked as Shuri and Catra walked up to him, with Shuri exclaiming,

"The *real* question is: *WHAT ARE THOSE* !" making T'Challa chuckle as she pointed at his sandaled feet, and Catra was once again left confused, humans could be so weird at times, "why do you have your toes out in my lab?"

"What, you don't like my royal sandals?" T'Challa asked with a smirk as he rested his foot on one of the lab stools, "I wanted to go old school for my first day" causing his sister to roll her eyes at this,

"I bet the elders *loved* that" she commented before picking up the two devices and putting them at his feet, "try them on" T'Challa then proceeded to remove his sandals and stood on the insoles, which then automatically formed a pair of technological looking black shoes around his feet, "completely automated," Shuri pointed out, "like the old American movie Baba used to watch. And I made them completely sound absorbent." Catra had a hard time believing this claim, and she *knew* how to get around places without making a sound, but she was once again amazed by her friend as T'Challa raised his foot and stomped on the metal floor with absolutely no sound at all,

"interesting" the king stated calmly, whilst Catra couldn't help but exclaim,

“Great Scott!” making Shuri chuckle for some unknown reason,

“Guess what I call them?” she encouraged her friend and brother with a smile, but with questioning looks on their faces, she then said, “sneakers” which was clearly another joke that they both didn’t get, “because you… never mind”

As they finished their circular tour of the lab, they came up to three mannequins one with T’Challa’s Black Panther suit and helmet on it, one with a silver tooth necklace, and the last one with a Gaudier looking golden necklace with what looked like real panther fangs set into it. “If you're going to take on Klaue,” Shuri told her brother, “You’ll need the best the Design Group has to offer.” She then gestured towards the suit, “exhibit A”

“My design” T’Challa nodded,

“Old tech,” Shuri plainly stated, and with a look from the king, she added, “ *functional* but *old* ” she then waved her hands in mock terror, “hey, people are shooting at me!” she then mimed putting something over T’Challa’s head “Wait, let me put on my helmet”

“enough” her brother smiled whilst Catra giggled at this sibling display, she had had her own fair share with Adora, it still felt weird that her previous sibling figure was now her girlfriend. Shuri then pointed at the remaining mannequins,

“Now look at these”

“Yeah, I don’t see any suits there, Shuri” Catra pointed out, “not that they aren’t nice necklaces, but I doubt they would do much to protect him with people shooting at him” this made Shuri chuckle once again,

“Just wait…” she told the Etherian, before looking back to her brother, who was looking at the golden one, “do you like that one?” she asked,

“Tempting,” the king agreed, before backing off and heading over to the silver one, “but the idea is to not be noticed, this one,” he pointed at the necklace and Shuri raised her left arm behind T’Challa’s back and activated one of her Kimoyo Beads, which glowed red and gave that little chime again, causing the king to look at her with a questioning look,

“Now tell it to go on” she told him, and as Catra watched, once again in awe, as another suit suddenly formed over the mannequin, all originating from the necklace! “oooh!” the Wakandan princess cooed at her work, it had similar aspects to T’Challa’s old design but was more sleek and clearly was designed to perfectly fit its wearer like a second skin.

“How is this possible?!” Catra exclaimed in amazement,

“The entire suit sits within the teeth of the necklace using nanite technology” Shuri explained before turning to her friend, “strike it” making Catra raise her eyebrow curiously,

“Anywhere?” she asked as she got into a light fighting stance, resulting in a nod from the princess. She breathed slowly, before delivering a powerful roundhouse kick to the suit, sending it flying to the other side of the room,

“Not that hard, genius!” Shuri exclaimed in an irritated tone, causing Catra and T’Challa to smirk

“You said to strike it” the Etherian sniggered as her friend rushed over to the suit and picked it up and brought it back over to them, “you didn’t tell me how *hard* ”

“I invite my brother to the lab and all you do is kick things around?” Shuri muttered as she replaced the suit in the same place it had been.

“Well maybe you should make it a bit stronger,” T’Challa suggested before noticing something odd, “eh? Wait a minute” the suit was now glowing purple in the place that Catra had kicked it,

“What is this?” the Etherian in question asked as she peered at the purple glow that was only visible in certain lines and Catra could just see how cool it would look if all the lines were glowing.

“The nanites absorb the kinetic energy and hold it in place for redistribution,”

“Very nice” T’Challa commented as Shuri stepped away and activated one of her Kimoyo beads, which opened a holographic screen that made Catra feel anxious about,

“Strike it again in the same spot, Catra” she announced, and T’Challa took a moved behind a desk that was behind Catra whilst stating,

“You are recording?” he asked curiously, causing Catra to feel like there was something she wasn’t being told as she got into her light fighting stance,

“For research purposes,” Shuri assured them, as Catra breathed out and once again roundhouse kicked the suit… only this time, as she made contact a small purple explosion of energy blew out of the suit and blasted her backwards with such force that she slid over the table behind her and crashed into T’Challa, ending up in a tangled heap on the floor with Shuri laughing loudly and mockingly.

“Delete that footage!” T’Challa and Catra both shouted as they got to their feet.

The Casino

That night, as they travelled through the busy streets of Busan, Catra was slouched on the back seat of a very comfortable car which, unbeknownst to the other humans outside, was made completely out of Vibranium. She was wearing a new suit that Shuri had arranged for her to wear to hide her obvious non-human features, this was composed of a magenta shirt, maroon trousers, slip-on black trainers (which she hated), and a hooded maroon jacket which she used to hide her ears, as well as a smart looking belt which held her tail against her back. She was also wearing a bow tie, but instead of doing it up, she just let it hang around her collar. She looked at T'Challa, who was sitting next to her. He was wearing a full black suit with a black tie and black boots. She also knew the girls in the front were dressed up for this too: Nakia was wearing a green dress that went looked like it was attached to her neck, whilst Okoye was wearing a flashy red dress with golden wrist bracers, and she was even wearing a wig to disguise her position as a Dora.

Once the car had been parked, Catra pulled up her hood and followed her teammates as they all got out of the car and walked down the street,

"This way" Nakia gestured ahead of them as she took the lead as they strode down the street,

"Bast willing this will go quickly and I can get this *ridiculous* thing off my head" Okoye complained as she flipped the wig's hair out of her face, making Catra chuckle,

"You know, it looks nice Okoye" she stated with a friendly smile, "just whip it back and forth and make the most of it," she was intending on letting her own hair grow back out again, as she missed having it so long,

“What?” the Dora asked in disbelief, “it’s a disgrace”

They followed Nakia for about a minute before she approached a fish merchant, who glared at them,

“annyeong sopia, eotteohge jinaeseyo” she said, and it took all of Catra’s willpower to not ask what she was saying. The conversation lasted about a minute and sometimes, the Etherian caught T’Challa and Okoye exchanging questioning glances at each other, but eventually the fish merchant smiled before nodding to an area behind her which was covered by a blue sheet. A man sitting in front of the sheet moved aside as Nakia walked past the fish merchant whilst saying, “gamsahabnida” with T’Challa, Catra and Okoye following close behind. The man pulled the sheet up and the team all walked under it and into a small room with a large metal detector which they all walked through, and as none of them tripped the alarm, Catra assumed that Vibranium was also undetectable by metal detectors. Once they were all through, two smartly dressed men opened a set of double doors in front of them to reveal the upper balcony of a buzzing, high-class casino. From their current view, they could see a bustling pit down below with game tables all over the place with people trying to win big, there was even a bar at the far end.

“Spread out.” T’Challa told them, “The buyer is likely already here” and with that, T’Challa and Nakia headed down to the pit whilst Okoye went to the left-hand side of the balcony whilst Catra took the right.

As Catra leaned on the edge of the balcony, looking at the numerous people below and to the sides of her, she heard T’Challa talking to Nakia through Shuri’s communication devices,

“The woman outside,” he said, “what trouble was she referring to?”, OK! Catra then decided to take up Shuri’s offer to teach her other languages! How could she keep up with conversations if she doesn’t understand half of them?!

“Ah… I got into a disagreement with some ivory traders” Nakia responded without a hint of regret, “made a bit of a mess”

“Hmm,” T’Challa responded, Catra now saw them descending the stairs to the pit, “and will there be any trouble tonight, Ms. Kenyan Heiress?”

“Depends on how quickly we finish the mission” Nakia announced before Okoye’s voice too came from the device,

“Can we please focus?” and on that, the two split up with Okoye saying, “thank you” as they did so. Catra smiled at this, it was too bad that Adora and Glimmer weren’t there, it would have been fun to hang out with them. She knew she was casting shade on Bow, and though she did respect the archer, he was rather irritating to her, always talking technical and bringing up her cat-like actions.

As she watched, Catra got a good view of her friends partly enjoying themselves, with T’Challa paying for some tokens to bet with whilst Nakia ordered a drink at the bar, it was only her and Okoye who didn’t do much, she knew the Dora took her job seriously and as for her, she refused to draw attention to herself as she bopped her head to the beat of the music that was playing at the time. She smiled as she closed her eyes, remembering the last time she had worn a suit, the date of the Princess Prom, and it was also the date that she danced with Adora for the first time, she just regretted ruining the party by kidnapping Bow and Glimmer, she shook her head to banish the memory just as she heard Nakia speaking,

“Eyes up.” She said as she reached for her drink, “Americans. I count three” Catra could see the group she was referring to and kept her beady eyes on them,

“five” Okoye corrected, “how could you miss Greased Lightning there behind you?” pointing out two men with slicked back hair with what seemed to be a whole bottle of hair gel.

“six” T’Challa announced as he approached a white man with smart grey hair and a smart suit who was playing one of the gambling games down in the pit, he noticed T’Challa approaching him and just watched with raised eyebrows as he approached before turning back to his game “just spotted an old friend who works for the CIA. It just got a little more complicated” now, Catra felt once again out of the loop,

“How complicated?” she murmured, hoping that someone would answer and was pleased when she heard Shuri’s voice come out of the communicator,

“that man knows about T’Challa being the Black Panther,” she explained, “he worked with the government to enforce the Sokovia Accords, which ended badly.” The Etherian need no more information, she had heard plenty of the Avengers little Civil War incident that was all because of those accords, even T’Challa had participated in that battle! At this point, T’Challa had made it to the table and placed down some counters,

“Agent Ross” he said to the man, who glanced at the king standing next to him,

“your Highness” he responded,

“you are buying from Klaue” T’Challa stated as he moved his counters to a part of the table that had the words, “Don’t Pass Bar” whilst this Ross guy placed his own on a section below that was labelled “Pass Line” (yes her eyesight is that good),

“what I’m doing or not doing on behalf of the U.S. government is none of your concern” the agent said with confidence, “now, whatever it is you’re up to… do me a favour and stay out of my way” T’Challa stared at the man and said calmly,

“I gave you Zemo”

“And didn't I keep it under wraps that the King of a third world country runs around in a bulletproof cat suit?” Ross retaliated,

sounding slightly irritated, "I'd say we were even. You really need to leave, *now* " before returning to the game,

"Klaue *is* leaving out that door with me" T'Challa insisted, "you've been warned" before walking away. At that point, the table runner announced something with Ross exclaiming,

"Hey, you won!" to the space that T'Challa had been a second ago, and at that point, an old man with white hair and moustache, a dark green jacket and sunglasses walked up to the agent and scooped up all of T'Challa's counters and brought them to his side of the table whilst saying,

"You know what? I think I'll just take these, bring 'em over here, and hold on for safekeeping" before chuckling.

"I *swear* I've seen that guy before" Catra said to herself as she watched the agent follow T'Challa whilst talking into his sleeve, if that was supposed to be inconspicuous, then he failed there.

"alright," he said as he approached T'Challa who was playing on another table, "Vibranium from the attack on Sokovia links back to a person that I'm not actually saying I'm here to make a deal with, but that deal will not be called off. When the dust settles you and me can work something out"

"I'm not here to make a deal." T'Challa stated to the agent and at this point, Catra could just feel like something was wrong. She looked all over the place and acknowledged numerous entrances, if she were still working with the Horde and she wanted to make a deal with one of the princesses, she would have chosen this sort of place, as it was the perfect setting for an ambush!

At that moment, Catra's highly tuned ears, albeit muffled by her hood, could pick up numerous sharp buzzing sounds coming from the entrance and as she glanced at the direction of the noise, she saw the man they were looking for, even though the photograph she had seen was old, this man looked almost identical to it, the

scruffy beard, the insane grin. But his left hand looked different to his right, and it had groves in it, almost as if it was a machine. He was flanked by eight burly men in black suits.

"Klaue" Catra murmured, as she continued watching the pit, "plus eight!" T'Challa was quick to turn his back to the entrance so as not to be noticed,

"General. Catra." He whispered,

"In position to secure our exit," Okoye whispered,

"Same here" Catra murmured under her breath as she watched Nakia heading to one of the tables near the bar.

"and the Vibranium?" T'Challa asked,

"I don't see it yet" Nakia said whilst she walked,

"I thought there were no weapons allowed in here." Okoye mentioned in curiosity,

"there's not supposed to be," Nakia explained as she neared a table.

"well, these guys must have missed that memo," Catra announced in a feint whisper without raising her head, as about three of these men had hung around where she was standing "as they are definitely armed and dangerous, but don't worry, I understand how these sorts of people think, the Vibranium will probably be in a fancy suitcase for a dramatic reveal" *that's what I would have done* , she thought to herself.

As Klaue approached Ross, Catra could just tell that even though the agent was playing it cool, he was clearly nervous.

"Well, that is *quite* the entourage" he said calmly, "you got a mixtape coming out?" the Etherian smiled at this, the man knew

how to quip.

“Oh, yeah” chuckled their target, making Catra’s jaw drop in shock, “yeah, actually, there is one. Yeah, I’ll send you the SoundCloud link, if you like.” He then turned to one of the men behind him, “hey, Dave, can you get the link to the tape?”

“ *Please* don’t make me listen to your music” Ross begged, “I just meant, you got a lot of people with you” Klaue chuckled on hearing this, Catra couldn’t believe this idiot was the same person who got into Wakanda and killed hundreds of people,

“He is so stupid” Catra murmured to herself, “there’s no way he could have gotten into Wakanda without help if he struggles with the sense of sarcasm”

“You think they’re for you?” Klaue asked with a grin, whilst placing a hand on Ross’s shoulder “don’t worry. I can do a deal with you all by myself, thank you very much” this made the Etherian in the room tense up, from two of the entrances she had noted before stepped a total of *six* extra men!

“people, six more just entered the room, this is a setup!” Catra hissed whilst eying two of the men that were near her.

“you got the diamonds?” Klaue asked, with his hand still rubbing Ross’s shoulder, resulting in the agent jerking his head towards the man whilst looking to the side before saying,

“ok. That’s enough” and shrugging of his hand as a woman with a silver briefcase walked towards them,

“we need to move on Klaue” Nakia whispered from her position,

“stand down,” T’Challa ordered, still keeping his back to the action, “we can’t afford a shootout”

“Vibranium?” Ross asked the man in front of him, who grinned, *here comes the suitcase,* Catra thought, and was left stunned when Klaue reached down, unzipped his trousers, reached in, and

pulled out a small package that was roughly wrapped in brown paper, before placing it on a table with a metallic thud, Catra would have facepalmed at this if she wasn't trying not to draw attention to herself; the dude had even written the words "fragile" on the package! Clearly she wasn't the only one disgusted by this, as Ross was looking at him in disbelief,

"oh, I was going to buy a fancy suitcase, but I thought I'd save myself some money." Klaue explained with a mad grin.

"its now or never," Nakia said as she started moving, at this point, Okoye hissed something in the Wakandan language at her, and Catra squeezed her eyes shut in despair at this! The men near the general had heard this and were advancing on her! She tried to walk away, but clearly changed her mind last second. She said something else in that unusual language before bringing out a Vibranium spear that extended from her hand as she proceeded to stab the man in front of her in the foot and bash his head against the pole, before tossing her wig at the man coming from behind!

"so much for stealth" Catra muttered as Okoye knocked one man over the edge of the balcony and alerting Klaue to them, who pulled out his gun and shouted,

"Wakandans! They're here!" whilst shooting at Ross, who was lucky enough to use his suitcase to block the bullets as he took cover, spilling the precious diamonds inside as he went!

The Chase

When the battle started, Catra could see the two men that were near her start moving through the crowd to help attack the Wakandans!

"oh no you don't!" she muttered to herself as she leapt up on the banister of the balcony and ran along the thin line, flipping around the support beams she came across until she finally caught up to them, she then span around a final support beam and delivered a powerful double footed kick to the stomach on the first man. The man flew into the wall and slumped to the floor, only stunned, but out of the fight for a while. Catra then flashed the second man a grin as she lowered her hood, "hey there," she said in her normal, flirtatious tone, "why don't you just give up now?" but sadly the man didn't listen to her warning and pulled out his gun and pointed it at her. Catra's smirk never left her face as she put her hands in her pockets and took one step back, and then the bangs sounded! BANG! BANG! BANG! Three shots were released as Catra simply used her cat-like agility to easily dodge each shot, all without taking her hands out of her pockets, she could see the man was getting angry at this as he released even more shots at her, this time she took out her hands and leapt onto the wall before bouncing to the support beam and then ricocheting towards the man who raised his weapon at the approaching Etherian.

For a split second, Catra wasn't in the casino anymore and instead was in a burning Fright Zone and in the mans place was Hordak with his arm canon pointed at her as she zoomed towards him! but with a single blink, she was back in the casino, and as she collided with the man, she slightly pushed the gun arm to the side with her left hand whilst landing a devastating punch to his chin with her right! She then spun in the air before hitting the ground, raised her left leg and brought it crashing down on the mans gun arm! She squeezed her eyes shut at the sound of shattering bones

as her leg stopped moving and she flipped herself over the now broken and bleeding man and landed a roundhouse kick to his back, sending him flying over the edge of the balcony! Suddenly her ears twitched as she heard movement behind her, she extended her claws and span around, slashing the face of the first man, who had gotten up and was advancing on her with a knife! The man charged at her and Catra quickly caught the man's wrists as he pushed her back into the banister behind her with him edging the blade to her neck!

"Catra!" she heard T'Challa shout from down in the pit as he fought, she looked down at the King who looked ready to help her, she then looked back at her assailant with a glare before using all her strength to push the mans wrists together and away from her body, before pushing his arms down and back, causing the man to stumble backwards before rushing her again, lunging the weapon at her head! she caught his wrist once again with one hand, and disarmed him with the other, sending the knife spinning into the air, and in a split second, the Etherian pushed the man down, rolled forward with him as he struggled, and as she exited the roll, she caught the knife and plunged it into the man's chest! The man gasped for breath with his eyes widened in terror as Catra stood up, grinning as she grabbed the suffering man and flipped him over the edge of the balcony.

Catra looked over the carnage that was happening around her, just like old times. Her grin quickly faded as she snapped out of her bloodlust, her eyes widened as she saw the red coating her claws, her breath quickened as she saw the two men she had fought not moving from where they had fallen, one with the knife still sticking out of his chest!

"What have I done?!" she whispered in fear, she had let out the emotionless killer inside her again! She was just about to run away, get out of this place, when her eyes fell on the man they were there for. Klaue was trying to escape the fray with the Vibranium, shooting his gun at the ceiling like the madman he

was! She could see T’Challa effortlessly jumping up to the balcony to intercept him, she wouldn’t let the king fight him alone! Catra ran over to the over side of the balcony as fast as she could, leaping on the scurrying people around her as she did,

“umbulali!” T’Challa shouted at the man, who attempted to shoot him, but he was out of bullets! Catra was almost there, now shoving people out of the way, she knew that he must have something else up his sleeve! And she was right, for Klaue quickly swapped the hand that was holding the Vibranium to leave his unusual hand free, as he raised them both.

“You know?” he asked as his arm split open to form some form of complex weapon! “You look just like your old man!” Catra finally got through the crowd at this and on hearing the weapon charging up, she leaped towards T’Challa, landed on all fours just behind him, grabbed a trolly that was full of money, and span in front of T’Challa, using the trolly as a shield just as Klaue fired! The blast was so powerful that it blew the trolly apart and sent Catra and T’Challa flying into the pit! Klaue looked at all the money floating down over the casino with a mad grin, “I made it rain!” he laughed, before running out of the casino with the rest of his backup.

“Catra!”

“Adora, let me sleep in” she moaned without opening her eyes, she then remembered where she was and her eyes snapped open and saw T’Challa looking down at her, “how much did you hear?” she asked with a worried look on her face,

“All of it” the king replied with a small grin before offering her his hand, which she took hold of and he pulled her onto her feet, “now hurry, we cannot let Klaue escape!” he then ran to the stairs, with Catra right behind him.

The duo ran out of the casino and into the street, with Catra quickly ditching her shoes as she went.

“Shuri!” T’Challa called as they ran down the road, easily keeping up with each other. Catra could swear she could hear the Wakandan princess squeeing with glee at this over the communicators,

“Wait!” Shuri exclaimed with concern in her voice, “which side of the rode is it?”

“Oh, for First-Ones sake!” Catra cried out as she ran, “just *drive* , princess!”

“Ok, calm down” Shuri muttered as the sound of a car’s engine zoomed towards them. And at the same time, T’Challa and Catra backflipped high in the air, with the former activating his suit which ripped his fancy outfit to shreds, and both landed on the roof of the empty car that Shuri was controlling from her lab back in Wakanda. “whoo!” Shuri cheered in excitement, “let’s go!”

“Punch it, Shuri!” Catra grinned at T’Challa who gave her a nod before they both focused on the road.

As they caught up to the Vibranium car that Nakia and Okoye were driving, Catra could see something that made their job even harder, there were *five* cars, and they were all identical!

“Which one is he in now?” Nakia asked, not that anybody knew, and to make their lives even *more* difficult the cars then split up, with three of them going right and the others continuing down the road!

“they’re trying to lose us” Okoye stated as they approached the turning,

“we’ll take the right” Nakia stated as the Vibranium car turned off to follow the three cars,

“we’ll take the other two!” Shuri called out, “I see a shortcut” the car then made a hard left turn into an alleyway with Catra and T’Challa holding onto the roof with their claws just to stay on. They soon caught up with the cars, which had both driven into a massive intersection and caused a massive blockade of crashed cars! “we’re not going to make it!” Shuri exclaimed as they approached the now incredibly sharp left turn.

“Keep going!” T’Challa ordered before flipping to the left side of the car and gripping the vehicle tightly with one hand and using his Vibranium claws on the road, and Catra watched in awe as the vehicle tilted so that only the left-hand wheels were on the ground as they turned and narrowly avoided the collision! He then let the car drop to all four wheels again and at the same time flipped himself onto the bonnet of the car,

“Whoo! Brother!” Shuri cheered,

“Amazing, sir!” Catra called over the rushing wind with a massive grin on her face, she couldn’t remember a moment when she had felt more alive than right now!

The men in the car right in front of them suddenly started shooting at them through the boot of their car, causing Catra to quickly retreat to behind the boot of their car, for T’Challa could take the bullets with his Vibranium suit, but she had no protection or any safe way of evading the bullets that were hitting the car, so all she could do was cower and watch the pro at work. T’Challa launched himself at the car in front gripping the back of it with his claws, and as Catra watched, the king moved to the roof and sliced it open with his claws as if it were tinfoil! He then widened the hole and without doing anything, the driver opened his door and leaped out, rolling on the rode until…

THUMP

“Hey, what was that?” Shuri asked with Catra looking mortified at what she just witnessed,

“Umm… speedbump?” she offered as they caught up to the out-of-control car,

“don’t worry about it” T’Challa announced as he jumped back on board “you’re doing great” the opposing car then crashed into a line of parked cars, causing a massive wreck! They then zoomed after the remaining car, which was also shooting at them from the boot!

“no chance this coat is made of Vibranium? Is there?” Catra asked as said clothing article flapped in the wind,

“nope, sorry” Shuri answered as the chased the car onto a bridge that was lit up with pink coloured lights, Catra then noticed that the bridge wasn’t the only glowing thing there,

“Hey, T’Challa!” she called, “look at your suit!” and indeed almost all the lines embedded into the suit were now glowing with the stored kinetic energy which was obviously from the bullets he was taking the brunt of, and as they closed the gap between them and their target, a large truck appeared in front of them!

“Shuri,” T’Challa called, “pull around the truck!” the car then zoomed forward and moved to the other side of the truck, hiding themselves temporarily allowing T’Challa to jump onto the trailer of the truck, run across to the side facing the opposing car, just as their car overtook the truck with Catra smirking at the confused faces of the men driving, before T’Challa landed on the bonnet of the black car and released the kinetic energy in a massive purple explosion of energy that completely flipped the car forwards! T’Challa was thrown back towards their car and Catra reached out and caught his arm and pulled him to the boot with her,

“You show off!” Shuri chuckled as T’Challa removed the eye coverings of his helmet to look Catra in the eyes

“Thank you” he said causing the Etherian to grin widely, “Klaue wasn’t in those cars, he must be with the others!” he then announced,

“You heard the king!” Catra called out, “step on it, Shuri!”

As they zoomed down the roads, Catra grinned widely once more as she saw the final car coming up in front of them,

“There he is!” she shouted, “speed up princess!”

“I’m going as fast as I can!” Shuri retorted through gritted teeth. The Etherian quickly moved back onto the roof of the vehicle alongside T’Challa, at that point, Klaue’s car took a hard right and as they turned the corner to continue the chase, they saw Klaue leaning out of the window with his arm cannon pointing at them!

“Oh First-Ones!” Catra gasped as the weapon fired and completely decimated the car!

“Brother! Catra!” Shuri exclaimed in fear as Catra and T’Challa were launched high in the air in opposite directions, they both kept their momentum as they hit the side of the tall buildings, running along the wall, before launching themselves at Klaue’s car! They both gripped onto opposite sides of the black car and used their claws to rip off the front wheels of the car and rolling onto the road as the car slammed into the curb and flipped onto its roof and skidded to a halt in the middle of a crowd of people.

As Klaue staggered out of the wreck, T’Challa once again removed the eye covers of his helmet as he advanced on the man,

“KLAUE!” he roared as he marched towards his target and extended his claws, “Did you think we would forget!?” Klaue quickly brought out his weapon and fired at the king, but this time all it did was discharge all the kinetic energy stored in the suit, it didn’t even knock T’Challa over! Suddenly, a sound filled the air around them,

“MMROWW!!!” and out of nowhere, Catra launched herself at Klaue with both claws extended and fangs bared! She crashed into the arm cannon, dug her claws in and ripped the thing off his arm with a hostile hiss before kicking him into the side of the car, sending the murderer crashing to the ground.

“Look at me, murderer!” T’Challa barked as Klaue struggled to his knees, “where did you get this weapon?! And as the man got to his feet he spat,

“you savages didn’t deserve it!” causing T’Challa to grab him by the throat and push him against the wreaked car and then hold him there by one hand whilst he raised the other in a fist, “oh, mercy! *King* , mercy!” he begged, T’Challa brought out his claws on his free hand as he said,

“every breath you take is mercy from me” and just as he was about to land the fatal blow,

“hayi ukumkani!” they turned to face Okoye and Nakia who had just arrived in a silver car driven by Agent Ross,

“ihlabathi libukele” Nakia stated, once again making Catra wish she understood what they were saying,

“come on. Guys.” Ross called as sirens started getting closer to them, “let’s go, huh?” Catra then realised that her hood was off and all the people around could see her for who she was! And there was no way they could just kill this man in front of everyone, they didn’t know the full story and would just brand T’Challa and herself as murderers! That was Klaue’s plan all along! She glared at him as he grinned madly at them. This was the worst night *ever* !

The Breakout

“So, what even are you?” Ross asked her as Klaue was locked up and chained to a chair in the room they were looking into through mirrored glass. It had been a long and sleepless night, the team had been taken to what was apparently called, a Black Site for the CIA. Catra (who was still wearing her fancy clothes, albeit a bit ripped,), T’Challa (who was now wearing a black hoody jumper and black trousers), Okoye (who was now also sporting a Burberry leather woven trench coat) and Ross (who was now wearing a more casual black jacket atop a grey long-sleeved top and black trousers) were watching Klaue, whilst Nakia kept watch near the entrance. The Etherian looked to T’Challa who gave a nod as if to say it was ok to tell him,

“I’m an Etherian,” she announced, “not sure how I got to this planet, or how to get home”

“So, an alien?” Ross said without even sounding surprised, which made Catra raise an eyebrow,

“How come you aren’t surprised?” she asked whilst looking at the agent in disbelief, as normally people would freak out if they knew they were meeting an alien,

“a few years ago, maybe I would have been surprised,” he told her without even turning away from the window, “but nowadays, aliens or alien related activity seem to be showing up more and more. I can no longer watch Doctor Who thanks to them… no offence” Catra shook her head and decided to investigate this Doctor thing later. Klaue was now staring at them pulling faces at the group even though he couldn’t see them.

“So, what do we do now?” Catra asked, hoping for anyone to answer, and with the awkward silence that filled the air, the Etherian realised that there was no plan yet.

“So, this is a big mess, huh?” Ross stated, “I figured we could go good cop, bad cop. I’ll talk to him first, then you guys go in.”

“Asinakumvumela ukuba athethe noKlaue yedwa” Okoye announced whilst glaring at Ross,

“Kungcono ukumyeka athethe noKlaue yedwa imizuzu emihlanu kunokutsala umdla apha.” T’Challa responded with a small smile, making Catra once again wish she had taken Shuri up on that offer to be taught the Wakandan language! “After your questioning, we will take him back to Wakanda with us” the king then said with confidence that brought back the smile to Catra’s face, even more so when she saw Ross’s surprised expression,

“What?” he stumbled, “no. look, I like you, a lot. But he’s in my custody now. He’s not going anywhere.” He then leaned forwards and whispered, “listen, I’m doing you guys a favour by letting you even be in here” he finished by tapping T’Challa’s shoulder which caused Okoye to spin around and glare at the man,

“Ukuba uthe waphinda wakuchukumisa, ndombethelela kule desika.” She announced, and Catra could *swear* that whatever she said was a threat.

“Does she speak English?” Ross asked

“When she wants to” Okoye responded coldly, still staring at the agent. After a few seconds of awkward silence, Ross straightened up.

“I’m going in, and when I’m done, you guys are up” he then made for the door of the soundproof room,

“Agent Ross” T’Challa called, making the man stop and face the royal, who placed his hand on Ross’s shoulder with a friendly look, “I do appreciate your help in Busan” causing the agent to look back at Okoye,

“You see that?” he asked calmly, “it’s called diplomacy” and then as he walked back to the door and opened it for them to briefly

hear Klaue singing, “your welcome” before entering the room, closing the door behind him.

“oof” Catra grunted with a hand over her heart, “that’s *gotta* sting!” this caused both her friends to chuckle,

“Okoye, play nice” T’Challa chuckled, causing the general to scoff playfully,

“Americans,” she muttered, before they all returned their focus to what was happening in the room.

Normally they wouldn’t be able to hear anything due to the soundproofing, but because of T’Challa sneaking one of the communicators that Shuri made onto Ross as he patted his shoulder, the group were able to all listen in on the conversation. So, as they watched Ross sit in a chair opposite Klaue, they could still hear him singing away and *boy* was the man tone deaf! He soon stopped on seeing Ross wouldn’t join in, before saying,

“You know, you really shouldn’t trust the Wakandans, I’m much more your speed”

“I don’t trust anybody,” Ross announced “not in this job. But what I am interested in is that arm cannon out there. Where did you get that?” Catra glanced behind herself and glanced at the mentioned weapon, “it’s an old mining tool that I made some adjustments to, but I can get you one if you like?” the liar, Catra knew already where the weapon was from, Shuri had done some digging and discovered that it was a mining tool only used in Wakanda!

“Why don’t you give me the name of your supplier, and I’ll ask them?” Ross asked, clearly not expecting what the weapons dealer was about to say,

“he’s right outside.” He pointed at the window with his only hand left, “why don’t you ask him yourself?” Catra tensed up at this, something seemed off.

“What? *T’Challa* ?” Ross asked in bewilderment, “you’re telling me that weapon on your arm is from Wakanda?”

“bingo” Klaue smirked as Ross got a bit comfier in his chair, “what do you actually *know* about Wakanda?”

“Um…shepherds, textiles, cool outfits”

“it’s all a front,” Klaue explained, “explorers searched for it for centuries. El Dorado, the Golden City. They thought they could find it in *South America* , but it was in *Africa* the whole time. A technological marvel. All because it was built on a mound of the most valuable metal known to man. *Isipho* , they call it. The gift. Vibranium”

“Vibranium, yeah” Ross nodded, “strongest metal on earth” but this made the man tied down scoff,

“it’s not just a metal” he stated, “they sew it into their clothes. It powers their city, their tech… their *weapons* ” this made Ross furrow his eyebrows,

“Weapons?” he asked curiously, Catra was now gripping a nearby desk, leaving puncture holes with her claws, the atmosphere was so tense that she could just feel like something was off! Why was Klaue so CALM!?

“Yeah,” he chuckled, “makes my “arm cannon” look like a leaf blower”

“that’s a nice *fairy tale* ,” Ross announced very calmly, “but Wakanda is a third world country, and you *stole* all their Vibranium” oh no no no no no NO! Catra was not informed of this! This is *bad* ! It was even worse now as Klaue was laughing hysterically at this,

“I stole…?!?” he stated between laughes before suddenly stopping and speaking in a growl as he even shook the chair he was in in anger, “ *all of it* !? I took a *tiny piece* of it! They have a mountain full of it! They’ve been mining it for thousands of years and they

still haven't scratched the surface." T'Challa started pacing at this, it was clear that even he was concerned about this, "I'm the only outsider who's ever seen it and got out of there alive. If you don't believe me, you ask your friend what his suit is made of, what his claws are made of" Ross thought for a moment before standing up and leaving the room.

As ross exited the room, he approached T'Challa with frustration on his face,

"Your father told the UN that Klaue stole all the Vibranium you had. But now he's telling me you have more?"

"And you actually believe what that man says?" Catra asked in curiosity, "when he is an obvious criminal who's been strapped to a chair?" this caused T'Challa to glance at her from the corner of his eye and Ross glared at her, "I'm just saying…" she stated with her hands up in mock surrender.

"How much more are you hiding?" Ross asked ominously, when all of a sudden, Nakia burst into the room shouting something in the Wakandan language,

"Kukho into eyenzekayo emva kwesakhiwo…" before the wall in the interrogation room behind them blew apart! And just as they were all about to run to stop Klaue from escaping, a man appeared in the hole, he was wearing a wooden mask that covered his whole face (and looked like it was a demon's head), as well as a blue ribbed boat-neck shirt, an armoured tactical vest, camouflage skinny jeans and combat boots. He was also brandishing a large gun, which he then opened fire, showering the room with a continuous spread of bullets which shattered the window and covered the people inside with bullet fire! Catra was quick to take cover behind a table and as she watched, Ross quickly pushed Nakia and himself down under the cover of the wall underneath the now smashed window, with T'Challa doing the same with some other CIA agents nearby as he activated his suit.

“Stand down!” the king shouted to any agents who were attempting to fight back as Okoye extended her spear. Suddenly, a small object was thrown through the window and rolled on the floor, and Catra eyes widened as she knew instantly what it was…

“GRENADE!” she shouted and tried to get up and cover it, but T’Challa was already there. He covered the bomb with his body, and as it exploded underneath him, his suit glowed purple instantly! He then bounced onto all fours and faced the opening, with two new men carrying a chortling Klaue into a van! T’Challa burst through the door and chased after the men, and Catra was about to follow, but was jerked back with a bolt of pain, she looked back and saw Okoye pulling her back by her tail!

“You can’t follow, you have no protection” she stated as Catra knelt down and took her tail back form the Dora,

“Ok, fair point,” she agreed, “but keep in mind that this is a real tail, so two things: one, if you pull it, it hurts. And two, it considered *very* rude to pull on someone’s tail. Just thought you should know.” She then saw something horrifying, Ross was lying on the ground still, in clear pain and his breathing was laboured! “Oh First-Ones!” she exclaimed as she rushed over to him and saw the cause of the issue, he had been shot! Okoye then ran to get T’Challa, calling out in the Wakandan language.

T’Challa hurriedly re-entered the room, to see two agents checking on Ross, one keeping pressure on the wound and the other checking his pulse, Nakia was stroking his face with worry plastered on her own. Catra meanwhile was struggling to know what to do in this situation! That’s the problem with living with a girl who can flash away all injuries! You forget basic medical care! So instead, she was just holding his hand in a comforting way, constantly whispering,

“you’re going to be fine” half praying to the First-Ones that that will be true.

“He just jumped in front of me” Nakia explained in concern, “I don’t think he will make it here, it hit his spine”

“There must be something we can do!” Catra argued, she had seen too much death in her life! Especially to someone she knew was on her side! T’Challa thought for a second before holding his hand out to Nakia,

“give me a Kimoyo Bead” he said, and Nakia did as he asked, detaching one from her bracelet and handing it to the king, who activated it, giving it a blue glow, before gently pushing it into the wound sending the blue glow around the injury, “this will stabilise him for now” he explained as Ross exhaled and lost consciousness, he then looked at the agents around them, before saying, “give him to us, we can save him” making Catra’s eyes widen, knowing what he was suggesting.

The Flight Talk

When Catra awoke, she could see nothing but darkness. Her legs felt wet and as she looked down, she saw she was submerged in green liquid up to her waist! She started panicking, and as she tried to move, she realised her arms were being restrained in a T-pose by hundreds of silver cables! She screamed and struggled in the grip of the cables as she realised her legs were being held by cables too! She wasn't even wearing her normal outfit anymore, instead she was wearing a sleeveless all white bodysuit with the horde symbol on the front! She then heard splashing from behind her, but she couldn't turn her head to face this person as she struggled against the cables,

"don't bother, Little Sister" came the calm voice of the being behind her, her eyes widened as she recognised this voice, it was Horde Prime! "Why struggle when you will be the first to think the way I do" she then felt him grip the back of her head and she then realised that her long hair, which she had been growing for years, had been cut short! At this point, Prime slammed his palm onto the back of her neck. it was cold and painful, just like she was used to. If she was being tortured for information, it would take a *lot* more than that!

"Ha! is that all you've got?" she chuckled as she heard Horde Prime splash away from her. Suddenly, she felt something cutting into the back of her neck! "AAAAAAAAHHHHHHGGGGG!!!!" she screamed in pain which was worsened as now she felt something circular and metallic on her neck, which was probably placed there by Prime just then! This *thing* , she could feel it connecting to her with wires and small spikes, she could feel it dig deeper into her body and as she started to lose consciousness, she could just hear Prime chuckle,

"Welcome to the Horde, Little Sister"

“NOOOOOOOOO!!!!” Catra screamed as she sat up and frantically felt the back of her neck, trying to rip off the device! She then acknowledged that she was back in the Royal Talon, the aircraft that she had watched T’Challa arrive in Wakanda in. It had been a long night, so T’Challa had told her to try to rest, so she had laid down on a sofa-like seat that wrapped around one side of the ship and drifted into a nightmare filled sleep. Her breathing was fast and panicked still and her eyes were wide,

“Hey, hey, hey!” Nakia exclaimed as she rushed over to the panicking Etherian’s side and wrapped her arms around her, “zola, ukhuselekile” Catra may have not understood what she said, but she could almost tell what it meant, she leant her head against Nakia and took deep breaths, enjoying the embrace. A few seconds later, Catra sniffed and straitened up.

“Thank you,” she whispered, as Nakia stood up to re-join T’Challa and Okoye, “T’Challa is lucky to have you”,

“don’t mention it,” the woman smiled as she faced her and placed a calming hand on her shoulder, “always feel free to ask for help if you need it,”

Half an hour later, once they were nearing Wakanda, Catra finally got to her feet and approached the rest of the team, the ship was clearly on autopilot as they were all looking down at Ross’s body that was lying on a table near the back of the ship. They were all looking troubled,

“our mission was to bring back Klaue,” Okoye pointed out, “we failed.” She then gestured to the man on the table, “this man is a foreign intelligence operative. How do we justify bringing *him* into our borders?”

“He took a bullet for me!” Nakia exclaimed in disbelief to the general’s statement,

“That was his choice.” Okoye responded coldly,

“What? Are we just supposed to let him die then!?” Catra argued, “if not for him, Nakia wouldn’t be here right now! Surely, we owe it to him to try and save his life now?”

“Let us consider that we heal him.” the general stated, “it is his duty to report back to his country.” She then turned to T’Challa, who hadn’t spoken a word during this whole argument, “And as king, it is your duty to protect ours”

“I’m well aware of my *duties* , general.” He snapped, “I cannot just… let him die, knowing *we* can save him” Catra smiled at this, the king had made a decree and Okoye *had* to follow his orders,

“Where exactly are we taking him?” the general asked, causing Catra to share a glance with T’Challa, they both knew *exactly* where to take Ross.

With Ross’s body now on a floating stretcher and covered by a blanket, the group of four rushed down the halls leading to Shuri’s Lab, Catra knew that if she had been able to heal *her* , then the Wakandan princess should be able to save Ross too. As they neared the final turning, Shuri walked around the corner to greet them with a smile, she then jogged over to them and lifted the blanket partially to get a look at the body,

“great!’ Shuri said with playful sarcasm in her voice as she followed them into her lab, “another broken white boy for us to fix. This is going to be fun” Catra once again decided to ask about this later, as Ross’s body was moved to the same alcove that she herself had woken up in on her first day in Wakanda. Shuri was quick to activate numerous holographic imaging devices in the alcove and pulled up another hologram that clearly showed Ross’s spine with one red section to show where he was shot. After a few minutes of silence, Shuri announced,

“He will live,” resulting in a sigh of relief from Catra’s direction. At that point, Shuri’s Kimoyo Beads gave a shrill chime and all the music that normally played in the lab suddenly stopped, the

Princess glanced at the bracelet on her wrist to identify the issue,

"W'Kabi is here" she said with sudden worry in her voice, and Catra knew why. W'Kabi apparently was eager to go with T'Challa on the mission so they could both kill Klaue, and T'Challa had insisted that W'Kabi stayed guarding the border of Wakanda with the promise that he would either kill Klaue himself, or he would bring him back to Wakanda. They had done neither of these. W'Kabi would not be happy on hearing this.

T'Challa gestured for Nakia, Okoye and Catra to remain hidden in the alcove before running up the spiral to confront W'Kabi.

"What is going on, brother?" they heard the Border Tribesman ask, "where is Klaue?"

"he's not here" T'Challa responded with regret in his voice, and after a short pause, he continued, "he slipped through our hands"

""slipped"?" W'Kabi repeated in disbelief, "for 30 years, your father was in power and did nothing. With you, I thought it'd be different. But it's more of the same." Then the sound of receding footsteps echoed through the silent lab, and it was clear as day to Catra that W'Kabi had lost all respect for the king, and that could lead to numerous problems later on.

The Introduction

A few hours later, Catra had reopened the HID, the memory of being unable to help through her not having protection still haunting her, that wouldn't happen again. The Etherian worked tirelessly, designing a suit that would allow her to protect Wakanda the best she could. First, she scanned in her old suit to get the right proportions and then got to work. She blended her casual suit with aspects of her spacesuit that Bow made for her, making this underlayer out of the same material as the underlayer of the Dora Milaje armour, she then went for the armour plating, and (not really surprising) she based a good deal of her armour on Adora's She Ra suit, giving herself the same metallic chest piece that Adora had on her She Ra outfit whilst merging it with a metallic belt that was based on the belt stripe of her own space suit, as well as adding a cuirass that connected to two metallic pauldrons (one on either shoulder) that resembled that of She Ra's from her first suit, as well as two bracers that were once again based on Adora's (First Ones did she miss her), she then added the headdress that she had made earlier and smiled at the result. At least she had designed something worthwhile, too bad she didn't dare ask Shuri to make it real, the girl had done too much for her already, so she saved her work and shut down the machine. Little did she know that Shuri was watching this whole scene with interest.

About an hour later, Catra was once again relaxing, enjoying the view of the trains outside whilst Shuri worked on the two devices that she had been working on the day Catra had arrived, which now looked clearly like technological gauntlets that were (obviously) panther based. The Etherian may have a love of action, but quite recently she had been starting to enjoy peaceful scenes more and more. The soft hum of Shuri's machines behind her added to the tranquillity and almost helped Catra forget all her troubles.

“All right, where am I?” Catra jumped at the sudden sound, spinning around to face the sudden noise with her claws outstretched, but it was just Ross, he had finally woken up.

“don’t scare us like that, colonizer!” Shuri exhaled, clearly just as startled as Catra was,

“Colon-wh… what?” he stumbled, “my name is Everett”

“Really?” Catra asked in disbelief, “I always thought your first name was Agent”

“No, it’s Everett” Ross announced, “I think you and Stark would get along fine” he then muttered, not that Catra didn’t hear it.

“Yes, I know” Shuri nodded, “Everett Ross, former air force pilot and now CIA”

“right” Ross said nonchalantly as he looked around, reminding Catra of her own initial reaction to waking up in this lab, “ok, is this Wakanda?”

“No, it’s Kansas” Shuri responded with sarcasm dripping from every word,

“How long ago was Korea?” he then asked sounding concerned for the answer,

“Oh, that was yesterday” Catra announced with a smile,

“I don’t think so,” Ross argued, “bullet wounds don’t just magically heal overnight” Shuri chuckled at this,

“They do here” she explained, “but not by magic, by technology” she indicated the equipment around them, at this before returning to her work, “don’t touch anything,” she announced as Ross started walking around, “my brother will return soon” at this, Ross finally looked out the window and slowly joined Catra’s side whilst looking out at the view of the utter beauty that was outside the lab.

“I know, right?” the Etherian announced as Ross gawked at the sight, “I enjoy the peacefulness of this view, it’s very calming”

“These train things,” Ross pointed out, “that’s magnetic levitation, right?”

“How am I meant to know, I’ve only been here about a week” Catra retorted before biting her tongue, “sorry, I’m still working on controlling my emotions”

“Well, obviously they are” Shuri announced, once again looking up from her work, this made Ross chuckle nervously,

“Obviously,” he repeated, “but I’ve never seen it this *efficient* ” he took another glance out the window before asking a question that hadn’t even occurred to Catra the whole time she had been there, “the light panels, what are they?” Catra took another glance at said panels that lined every train track, shining light onto the trains as they passed.

“Sonic Stabilizers” the Wakandan princess stated,

“Sonic what?” Catra asked, with that answer not explaining the purpose and just confusing her and the CIA agent next to her,

“In its raw form, Vibranium is too dangerous to be transported at that speed,” Shuri explained as she joined them at the window, “so I developed a way to temporarily deactivate it.”

“there’s Vibranium on those trains?” Ross asked in disbelief,

“there’s Vibranium all around us” Catra pointed out, “its also probably how Shuri healed you?” she glanced at the princess at this, who gave a friendly grin and nodded,

“exactly” she chuckled at Ross’s flabbergasted expression as she returned to her work desk, sending Catra into a fit of giggles too, this fun moment was unfortunately short lived. At this point, Shuri’s Kimoyo Beads trilled their usual technological chime to state that someone was calling (yes, Catra had noticed the

different sounds of the beads meaning different things), so Shuri quickly flipped one of the beads into the palm of her hand and a holographic image of Okoye appeared just as Shuri signalled them to stay silent, Ross was clearly even more flabbergasted at the sight of the projection, but kept his mouth shut.

"Where is T'Challa?" Okoye asked, "his Kimoyo Beads have been switched off."

"Well, we are not joined at the hip, Okoye" Shuri smiled cheekily, but none of them were prepared for what the general was about to say,

"a man showed up at the border who claims to have killed Klaue!" the Dora announced,

"What?" Shuri exclaimed in disbelief,

"W'Kabi is transporting him, as we speak, to the palace." Okoye continued, clearly concerned, "we need to find your brother" Shuri then pulled up the file on this man on the HID, showing the man they were dealing with: he had a similar complexion as Shuri, he had black hair that consisted of short dreadlocks that were flipped to the right whilst he had a side fade on the left, he also sported a small beard and moustache (though not joined), though his clothing looked familiar to Catra: a blue ribbed boat-neck shirt, an armoured tactical vest, camouflage skinny jeans and combat boots. Where had she seen that combo before?

"An *outsider* ?" Shuri asked as his details came up on the hologram,

"No, a *Wakandan* " Okoye stated with clear disbelief in her voice,

"he's *not* a Wakandan," Ross interrupted as he got a look at the man, "he's one of ours"

The Killmonger

After finally tracking T'Challa down, the team all assembled in the lab where Ross started giving them the lowdown on this man they were dealing with,

"Erik Stevens" Ross explained, "graduated Annapolis age 19, MIT for grad school."

"Are you speaking another language?" Catra interrupted, causing the CIA agent to do a double take,

"Those are big things to do on earth," he explained before continuing, "he joined the SEALs and went straight to Afghanistan where he wrapped up confirmed kills like it was a videogame. Started calling him Killmonger. He joined a JSOC ghost unit. Now these guys are serious; they will drop off the grid so they can commit assassinations and take down governments." Now this is starting to sound like something Catra understood, there were a few parts she didn't understand, but she guessed the acronyms weren't that important.

"Did he reveal anything about his identity?" T'Challa asked the group, as he approached the holographic image of the Killmonger,

"He has a War Dog tattoo" Shuri explained, "but we have no record of him"

"So why is this such a big deal?" Catra asked, "the guy must have killed a "War Dog" whatever that is, and copied the tattoo, so he is clearly a fake"

"Yes, except only a Wakandan can give this type of tattoo" Nakia pointed out before pulling down her lower lip to show a blue tattoo of a few Wakandan symbols on the inside of her lip, this tattoo seemed to be glowing faintly, Nakia then released her lip and closed her mouth,

“ok then, I’m at a loss” Catra announced, “if a Wakandan is the only person who could give that tattoo to someone, you must have a traitor in your midst, but I highly doubt anyone here *would* betray Wakanda” she noted that as she said this, T’Challa’s eyes widened, realising something that he decided not to tell the others before they all rushed to the throne room, as Killmonger was bound to arrive at any second.

“Is this man Wakandan or not?” the River Tribe elder asked,

“sixelele ukuba kuqhubeka ntoni” the Mining Tribe elder said in the Wakandan language. They were all waiting in the throne room, with T’Challa sitting on his throne with Shuri by his left and Catra on his right with Okoye standing next to her, not to mention all the elders siting on their seats on the small square of cracked red clay in the centre of the room. At this point, the grand entrance doors swung open to reveal the man who claimed to have killed Klaue, with his hands chained behind his back, with M’Baku leading him into the room, they were also flanked by two soldiers who, Shuri had told the resident Etherian, were members of the Kings Guard, who were a special force of elite warriors dedicated to the protection of Wakanda, similar to the Dora Milaje, except the Dora’s job was protecting the royal family specifically. The atmosphere was so thick you could have cut it like a knife.

“thetha” T’Challa said, Catra knew this one, he was telling the man to speak, for which W’Kabi did the honour of translating to English,

“I’m standing in your house,” Killmonger announced, “serving justice to a man who stole your Vibranium and murdered your people. Justice *your* king couldn’t deliver.” That did it, T’Challa raised from his seat and approached the man with Okoye and Catra following close behind, the former brandishing her spear whilst the Etherian extended her claws, at the same moment, more of the Dora Milaje marched into the room, ready to strike,

“I don’t care that you brought Klaue.” T’Challa whispered into the man’s ear, not that it avoided Catra’s enhanced hearing, “only reason I don’t kill you where you stand is because I know who you are. Now, what do you want?” Killmonger looked behind the king and at the throne,

“I want the throne” he announced for everyone to hear, causing the elders to chuckle,

“kulunga kwam. itrone?” the Mining Tribe elder said through the giggles, but Catra could tell that this man was hiding something, some form of ace-in-the-hole, she knew because if she were in his situation, she would have a good reason for saying such a thing.

“y’all sittin’ up here comfortable” Killmonger stated, “must feel good. There’s about two billion people all over the world that looks like us, but their lives are a lot harder. Wakanda has the tools to liberate ‘em all.”

“And what tools are those?” T’Challa asked, though he clearly knew what was coming, Catra did too, this all seemed very similar to her time in the Crimson Waste and her confrontation with Tung Lashor.

“Vibranium” the man said calmly, “your weapons”

“our weapons will not be used to wage war on the rest of the world” T’Challa announced, “it is not our way to be judge, jury and executioner for people who are not our own”

“not your own?” Killmonger repeated with a small grin, “but didn’t life start right here on this continent? So ain’t all people your people?”

“I am not king of all people” T’Challa argued, “I am king of *Wakanda* , and it is my responsibility to make sure our people are safe and that Vibranium does not fall into the hands of a person like you”

“son” the Queen spoke up at this point, “we have entertained this charlatan for too long. Reject his request”

“Oh, I ain’t requesting nothing” Killmonger pointed out, “ask who I am”

“You are Erik Stevens” Shuri called out as she partially approached the man, “an American black operative. A mercenary nicknamed Killmonger. That’s who you are” Catra smiled at this, he had just been outed, and she knew that if he wanted the throne, he would have to do the ritual combat thing, but only a member of Wakanda’s tribes or a person of royal blood could make that challenge, so he had no way of winning!

“that’s not my name, Princess” Catra did a double take on this, that was something she would have said in his place! In fact, this man’s laid-back attitude yet background sinisterness reminded Catra of herself back at the start! “Ask me, King” the man said, looking T’Challa in the eyes with a wide grin,

“No,” the king refused,

“Ask me” Killmonger repeated, with an added sinisterness to his tone, and at this, T’Challa turned his back on the man and walked back to the throne whilst signalling the guards behind him,

“Take him away” and as the guards grabbed hold of the man by his arms and started dragging him out of the room, Catra thought that was the end of it… until the River Tribe elder shouted,

“Ungubani?” and Catra knew from experience that that meant “who are you?” in Wakandan,

“ndinguN'Jadaka, unyana kaNkosana uN'Jobu!” the man shouted, causing pandemonium among the elders, but catra was confused as to what he said, she looked over at Shuri to see if she would translate, but the Wakandan princess looked shocked at whatever Killmonger had just said, whatever he said was clearly his ace-in-the-hole!

“unyana kaNkosana uN'Jobu?” the Mining Tribe elder asked in disbelief,

“I found my daddy with Panther Claws in his chest!” Killmonger ranted in English, making Catra’s eyes widen, his father had been murdered by the Black Panther? “You ain’t the son of a king, you the son of a murderer!”

“UYANDIXOKA!!!” the queen shouted angrily, “LIES!”

“I’m afraid not, Queen Mother,” W’Kabi announced coldly as he revealed a gold chain with a silver ring on it, this clearly proved what he said was true with the Queen holding out her hand for the ring, whilst the elders gasped,

“inzala kaN'Jobu” the Mining Tribe elder gasped, and just when Catra felt like she would never get an explanation, Killmonger said two words to the Queen that explained *everything* ,

“hey, Auntie” Catra gasped and covered her mouth with her hand at this, she had expected an ace-in-the-hole, but not something as world-shattering as this! “I’m exercising my blood right, to challenge for the mantles of king… and Black Panther” the silence that followed was deafening, Catra knew that T’Challa couldn’t just turn him away now, and he clearly knew about this connection before the reveal, no wonder he didn’t tell if his own father killed this man’s father, who was also a member of the royal family! After about ten seconds of silence, the queen turned to her son,

“Do not do this, T’Challa” she begged,

“As the son of Prince N’Jobu,” the Border Tribe elder announced, “he is within his rights.”

“He has no rights here!” the queen snapped,

“The challenge will take weeks to prepare!” the River Tribe elder pointed out, all this whilst T’Challa kept his back to them,

“Weeks?” Killmonger asked incredulously, “I don’t need weeks! The whole country ain’t gotta be there, I just need *him* , and somebody to get me outta these chains” T’Challa took the ring from his mother as he sat down on his throne and looked at his subjects and his challenger, he looked disappointed, as he looks at the new ring on his middle finger,

“T’Challa?” the queen asked, “what do you know of this?” but instead of answering her, and even though Catra was shaking her head furiously, knowing how this could go, he looked Killmonger straight in the eyes and said,

“I accept your challenge”

The Fall of T'Challa

As Catra and Shuri walked through the tunnel that led to the Warrior Falls, flanked by four Dora Milaje, Catra stopped and grabbed Suri by the wrist, Stopping her from progressing. At the confused looks of the Dora, Shuri said,

“it’s ok, give us some space please” and they nodded respectfully before marching ahead, “what is it?” she then whispered, causing Catra to take a shaky breath, nervous about what she was about to say,

“That man, Killmonger…” she whispered with worry, “he reminds me of someone I know, and not in a good way. I fear I know how this will end, and it won’t end well if I’m right” Shuri looked nervous at this,

“Who are you on about?” she asked, “who does he remind you of?” the Etherian took a deep breath and readied herself for this,

“me” she announced, “who I was before, and so I fear that he is a man with nothing to lose and everything to gain, which I know from experience makes a monster out of a person, with them not even realising it because their heart grows so cold that they feel no remorse for anything they do until it’s too late”

The Falls seemed darker without the whole country cheering and dancing on the cliff face, but Shuri still had belief in her brother, and Catra prayed to the First Ones that her faith was right. Soon everyone was there; the elders, the Dora Milaje, W’Kabi, and the royal family as well as Catra, all of them watching Zuri apply black face paint to T’Challa, who was once again in his dark purple trunks as well as holding his short Vibranium spear in his right hand and his shield in his left, the same as before. Killmonger was still wearing his armour and was holding a sword in his right hand and a similar spear to T’Challa’s, except he quickly snapped it’s

shaft with his foot to make it more manoeuvrable, another thing Catra would have done!

“he’ll never beat T’Challa” Shuri pointed out with confidence, “he should have just come to the first challenge and gotten it over with.” This confidence didn’t convince Catra, she kept having flashbacks to the Crimson Waste, remembering when she herself had challenged the leader of a land that wasn’t her own to a battle with equal stakes, her only hope was that Shuri was right and that T’Challa could beat this guy.

Zuri brought out the small bowl that contained the potion that would take away T’Challa’s powers and started pouring it down T’Challa’s throat, before announcing,

“The king will now have the strength of the Black Panther stripped away” and as he stepped back T’Challa once again started spasming with his veins expanding and his muscles contracting as the potion stripped him of his powers, and once again, the drums started up in a smooth beat and everyone had once again crossed their arms and were bouncing their arms to the drumbeat, just like before. But this time, T’Challa seemed to take this potion better than before, so Catra found her eyes drifting over to Killmonger, who was staring at Zuri with a look of recognition on his face, was Zuri a part of this secret past too?! Zuri looked away from the man with shame written on his face, confirming Catra’s theory and that he too knew about Killmonger’s connection to the throne before the reveal in the throne room.

Just as T’Challa was recovering, Catra noticed Nakia arrive, but there was no sign of Ross.

“Nakia!” she hissed jerking her head to Shuri and her mother. Nakia approached as far as she could, stopping at Okoye’s side,

“Where is agent Ross?” the Dora asked in a whisper,

“I locked him in the office,” she responded, “He’s not going anywhere” at this point, T’Challa got to his feet and approached his opponent,

“This is your last chance,” he said clearly, “throw down your weapons, and we can handle this another way” and to Catra’s surprise, Killmonger instantly plunged the sharp ends of his weapons into the ground by his feet, sticking them there! For a second, she believed that he had changed his mind, but then…

“I lived my entire life waitin’ for this moment” he announced before unstrapping his armoured vest, letting it drop into the water, “I trained, I lied, I *killed* , just to get here” he then removed his shirt to reveal his entire body was covered in tiny scar marks! All in a neat order too! Did he do this to *himself* ? “I killed in America, Afghanistan, Iraq.” He then threw the shirt to the side, “I took life from my own brothers and sisters right here on this continent!” he really is mad! *Catra* mad! He then reclaimed his weapons and pointed his spear at T’Challa “and all this death… just so I could kill you” T'Challa glanced a Zuri and gave a small nod, causing the man to sigh before announcing reluctantly,

“Let the challenge… begin!” banging his spear on the ground as he did before quickly moving to join the onlookers.

Killmonger was quick to rush T’Challa! With the former showing expert blade work, dealing blow after blow to T’Challa, who showed his expert defensive skills by blocking each and every hit with his shield! T’Challa then started attacking with his spear, blocking and being blocked by Killmonger’s own lunges with both his weapons! This fight seemed too well balanced! It went on like this for a good minute until T’Challa finally gained the upper hand and swept Killmonger’s legs out from under him, sending him crashing into the water! But instead of ending it there, he only pointed his spear at the man and shouted,

“Yield!” not this again! This man had nothing to lose if he died! This was a battle of Kill-or-Be-Killed, and Catra knew it! And as if

to prove that point, Killmonger took the opportunity to get back up onto his feet and resumed fighting! This time more ferociously than before, his blows collided with the shield time and time again! T'Challa managing to get under his guard, causing a large gash on Killmonger's face! This enraged Killmonger, who charged at T'Challa like a bull, constantly blocking his attacks and even managed to kick him onto his back! T'Challa quickly recovered and continued fighting, but he was clearly tiring now! This gave Killmonger the advantage, now getting under the king's guard and landed a nasty gash to his thigh, bringing the leader down on one knee! T'Challa defended himself as best he could, as blow after blow rained down on his shield,

"SNAP OUT OF IT T'CHALLA!" Shuri screamed at her brother, but as the king tried to push against his opponent and get back onto his feet, Killmonger blocked another attack and following up with a nasty slash on T'Challa's stomach! He then proceeded to disarm T'Challa of his spear before catching his shield arm and slashing a deep cut into his bicep! This act caused T'Challa to drop his shield, and to the horror of the onlookers, as he attempted to continue fighting with his bare fists, Killmonger managed to thrust his spear into the king's ribs! As Killmonger stared into the eyes of his enemy, he quickly removed the spear, causing the king to collapse to his knees! He then dropped the spear and attacked with his sword, with T'Challa *just* managing to block it, but receiving two strong punches to the face that sent the rest of him into the water!

"Come on, get up" Catra could hear Nakia willing the king, but she already knew, it was all over for T'Challa. NO! she refused to believe that! She knew from experience that miracles can happen! One was bound to happen here and let T'Challa win, right? But as fate loved being cruel, Catra could only watch as T'Challa tried once more to get up but was punched down once more by Killmonger. As T'Challa laid on his side, blood pooling into the water around him from his various wounds, Killmonger glared down at him,

“This is for my father” he spat as he raised his sword, ready to behead the king! But as he swung the sword down, it was blocked by a long spear alongside a cry,

“Erik!” it was Zuri! He was interfering with the battle!

“Zuri, no” T’Challa murmured, as Zuri disarmed the man, with a cry of,

“Stop!” Okoye and the Queen called out in attempts to stop the shaman, but the pleas fell on deaf ears, “I am the cause of your father’s death, not him.” Zuri announced, “take me”

“DON’T DO THIS!” Catra screamed, knowing what was coming and not even knowing if she was shouting to Zuri or to Killmonger! After a few heart stopping seconds… Killmonger glared angrily at the man before taking his spear and shouted,

“I’ll take you *both* , Uncle James!” before plunging the blade into the man’s heart! T’Challa screamed in despair as his friend died In front of him! the body crashing into the water right next to the struggling king! Killmonger was quick to ditch the weapon before advancing on T’Challa, who out of anger, grabbed Killmonger’s sword from the water, still screaming in anguish as he tried to strike down the man, but collapsed after one swing! It was worse that he wasn’t even close to the man with that swing. Catra could feel tears in her eyes as she watched the pathetic sight, “is this your king? Huh?!” Killmonger called to the audience as he dodged all the angered attacks T’Challa attempted, “is this your king?!” he then caught T’Challa’s final lunge and disarmed him whilst delivering a devastating punch to his chest, before kneeing him in the head! Sending the king tumbling to the ground again! “The Black Panther! Who’s supposed to lead you into the future?!”

“Come on brother!” Shuri shouted, tears streaming down her face at the horrible sight! And Catra just stood there, ridged, for she had been right… this man was just like her before she had been turned good.

“is there nothing that can be done?” she heard Ayo ask, with no reply needed… they all knew how this would end, but they all refused to believe it.

“Him?!” Killmonger continued his rant, “he’s supposed to protect you!” T’Challa attempted one more swing at the man, who simply ducked under the blow and scooped T’Challa over his shoulders before walking over to the edge of the falls!

“No!” the queen gasped.

“No!” Nakia exclaimed.

“no” Catra whispered. All before Killmonger tossed the limp body over the edge!

“NOOOOOOOO!!!” the queen screamed in anguish at her son’s death! Shuri was sobbing loudly with her mother, and as for Catra… well, she may have been silently mourning the king, but she also knew how this monster would think, and now he was legally the king, he could order for the rest of the royal family to be executed immediately! So, she knew that she needed to get them out of there, FAST!

“Nah. *I’m* your king” Killmonger announced as he approached the audience,

“Your highness, Shuri, we need to leave, NOW” Catra whispered as she quickly shuttled the weeping royals to the nearest tunnel, with Nakia joining them and hurrying them along.

The Last Hope

“we need to find somewhere safe to hide” Catra announced as they ran, at that moment, it didn’t matter which direction they were running, it only mattered that they put as much distance between them and Killmonger as possible.

“I know a place” Nakia called out as she took the lead helping the former Queen along whilst Catra stayed in between her and Shuri, who was bringing up the rear. Nakia led them to the outskirts of a jungle she said was called “the Dead Jungle”, it was a rather ominous name, but it was better than nothing. Nakia quickly gave the three of them blankets to disguise themselves in case they were found before going back to the palace to get “help” which Catra acknowledged as her going to get Ross and Okoye, before she left, she gave the queen one of her weapons, which was called a Ring blade, and told them there was a clearing about 50 meters in from the direction they were facing, which was where they were to wait for her. But as they walked, Catra and the Queen heard a thump behind them and looked back to see Shuri, who had collapsed to her knees and was crying and quivering in fear.

“you keep going,” Catra told the queen, “we’ll catch up” the former royal looked reluctant to leave her daughter, but eventually nodded and moved ahead whilst the Etherian quickly rushed over to the little girl and hugged her tight, holding the shaking princess close “sh sh sh!” she whispered as Shuri cried into her shoulder, stroking her hair in an attempt to calm her, “its ok, I’m here, you will be fine, I won’t let anything happen to you” Shuri sniffed without moving from the embrace,

“p-p-promise?” she stuttered, causing Catra’s eyes to widen, a memory flashing over her eyes:

She and Adora as kids, sitting on a bed in the Fright Zone, with her trying to cover herself with a blanket. Young Adora removed the blanket from her head causing her to hiss at her friend,

“Catra, its ok, it’s just me” she told her as her younger self wiped her tear-filled eyes, “it doesn’t matter what they do to us, you know? You look out for me, and I’ll look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other.”

“You promise?” young Catra asked, looking at her best friend with hope,

“I promise” young Adora said as the memory faded back to the jungle.

Catra looked down at the quivering young girl in her arms, remembering how kind she had been to the Etherian holding her, even when she had no right to. At that moment, she made her choice,

“I promise” she whispered, before helping the girl to her feet and holding onto her as they continued walking to the clearing. As they arrived, Catra let Shuri stumble over to her mother, who had been waiting for them in the clearing, the former queen took the still crying Shuri into her arms and they both sobbed, Catra decided to keep watch, vowing to keep her promise, for as long as she lived. She too sniffed silently as she remembered the king she had gotten to know, so honourable and noble and full of heart, trusting his sister’s judgement about her to the extent of letting the Etherian join in on a very important mission for Wakanda. “I’m so sorry T’Challa” she whispered to the sky, “I wish I could have done something to stop this”

Night had fallen, Nakia still hadn’t returned, but in the distance, Catra could see torchlights approaching a structure about a mile

away, her claws were out and ready for anything that came after the royal family.

“first Baba,” Shuri sniffed in her mother’s embrace, “and now my brother…” she then started crying again, her voice breaking as she said, “mama, we didn’t even get to bury him!” Catra felt a single tear roll down her cheek, she too was upset about T’Challa’s death, but she had to be strong, at the very least for Shuri. The sound of a branch snapping nearby caused the Etherian to lurch towards the sudden noise, ready to fight off anyone who found them!

“it’s me!” Nakia announced with her hands in the air, she was now wearing a green blanket, and had a similarly disguised Ross trailing behind her,

“Nakia,” the former Queen sighed in relief before her eyes landed on Ross and she raised the Ring blade to face him, “who is this man?”

“he’s a friend of T’Challa’s, he saved my life” Nakia explained hurriedly,

“I can confirm that” Catra nodded, before looking around for the only missing person, “Nakia, where’s Okoye?”

“Okoye’s not coming,” the River Tribe warrior confessed sadly, “she and the Dora Milaje will serve the new king”

“Great!” Catra muttered sarcastically, “the best warriors of Wakanda working with a murderer, now *that’s* a smart move!” she could still see that structure in the distance, except most of the torches were gone now, “Nakia, Your Highness?” she called whilst pointing at the structure, “what is that place?” Nakia joined her side and looked at where she was pointing,

“The hall of kings” she explained, “its where they keep the garden of the Heart Shaped Herb, the new king is probably there right now getting his powers” Catra thought about this for a moment,

“Will he be unconscious for the whole time he is gaining these powers?” she asked, resulting in a confused look from the Wakandans,

“Most likely, why?” Shuri asked, causing Catra to grin, a plan brewing in her head,

“Because I have an idea…” she announced, “Nakia, promise me you will protect them whilst I’m gone” she stared into the woman’s eyes at this, making her inhale a sharp breath,

“I promise” she nodded, “but where are you going?”

“As far as I’m aware…” Catra turned in the direction of the Hall of Kings before turning her head to look back at her friends, “I’m following Bast” before running forward, zooming through the thick jungle, using her feline features to leap across the trees like she was a panther herself! She had one chance to do this! One last hope!

Catra managed to find a small tunnel that led into the Hall of kings without anyone noticing her, determination etched on her face as she crawled through the tunnel coming out into a cavern with large purple flowers in individual garden beds as well as water filled canals and in the centre was a stone platform with a patch of sand large enough for a grown man to lay down in it. There were stone paths leading away from this platform, going alongside the edges of the room and the garden beds. Catra silently cursed herself as she saw that Killmonger was awake, clearly having just received the powers of the Black Panther.

“The Heart-Shaped Herb did that?” he asked in amazement, he looked at the beds of the precious gift surrounding them, “this all of it?” he asked,

“Yes,” one of the shaman’s nodded, “so when it comes time for another king, we will be ready” Catra forced herself to stay hidden as Killmonger approached the shaman, malice in his eyes,

“Another king?” he asked incredulously, resulting in the shaman nervously nodding, “yeah, go ahead and burn all that” the Shaman was shocked at this,

“My king, we cannot do that” she announced, “it is our tradition…” but she didn’t manage to finish that sentence for Killmonger quickly grabbed the shaman by the neck and lifted her off her feet!

“When I tell you to do something” he smirked as the woman choaked in his grip, “I *mean* it.” Before letting her drop to the floor, luckily, she was unharmed, “burn it all!” Killmonger shouted, and as Catra watched, all the shamans grabbed nearby torches and started reluctantly setting fire to the garden! Catra knew she had to act now or never! She silently crept out of her tunnel and over to the nearest bed, remembering the story Shuri had shown her, she reached into the nearest flower and twisted out the precious herb centre, before retreating back into the tunnel, and as she glanced back at the carnage of the burning garden, Catra vowed that Killmongers reign will be short, even if she had to kill him herself!

The Great Gorilla

The cold wind bit at their faces as the group trudged through the snow-covered mountains, they all hugged their blankets close in desperate attempts to stay warm in the harsh environment. Catra had returned to them with the herb restoring their hope, except there was one problem, they believed for some reason that *Catra* should be given the powers of the Black Panther, which she instantly refused, partially due to her already possessing the same abilities and partially due to her wanting a Wakandan to use this power, as it belonged to them, not to her or Killmonger. So now they were heading to the only person Catra deemed strong enough to take down the new king with the abilities the herb would bestow.

"So, where are we going again?" Ross asked, as they trekked up the mountain path,

"we're taking the Heart-Shaped Herb to Jabariland," Nakia explained without looking back at the American. Ross was clearly confused on hearing this,

"Heart-Shaped Herb? What is that?" he asked,

"It gives whoever takes it heightened abilities." Shuri explained,

"it's what made T'Challa so strong" Nakia added, on this, the queen stopped,

"Catra" she called, getting everyone's attention, the Wakandans huddled together as Catra approached the queen as she continued, "I don't like this, the Herb belongs to us. We may be creating an even bigger monster with M'Baku"

"What do you suggest then?" the Etherian asked, "I refuse to take power that isn't mine to have, and who else here has the battle skills we need?" the queen looked at Nakia on this,

“Nakia, *you* should take it” the River Tribe warrior looked her queen in the eyes with sadness still plastered on her face,

“I am a spy with no army” she announced, “I wouldn’t stand a chance”

“M’Baku might be our only hope, your highness” Catra added, “we have no other option”

“Call me Ramonda” the queen gave her a small smile at this, “and ok, we’ll go” at that, they continued down the path, heading towards an ominous carving in the mountain that resembled M’Baku’s mask from the first ceremonial battle.

“Oh, boy!” Ross sighed as they pressed forward, but Catra heard something over the sound of the wind rushing past and held out her arm to stop everyone. It was a chanting that resembled that of a gorilla’s hoots, getting closer and closer. Soon, along the path came numerous Jabari warriors!

“Look down, stay calm” Nakia muttered hurriedly and as they all looked down, Catra couldn’t help but mutter,

“Take us to your leader”

M’Baku’s throne room was very different to T’Challa’s. this room was open to the elements due to the lack of walls, in the place of the walls were countless birch logs of varying length all suspended from the ceiling, Catra couldn’t tell if these logs were functional or just for decoration. The view of the Jabari Village was breath-taking in the late night, and there, sitting on a wooden throne, flanked by two Jabari warriors, was M’Baku himself, still holding that staff/club from before. The guards that brought them in banged their spears on the floor, making all of them jump at the sudden bang. After recovering from the scare, Ramonda stepped forward,

“My son…” she began, clearly struggling to remain strong when saying this, “was murdered in ritual combat”

“Were the odds fair?” the Jabari leader asked,

“Yes, but…” Nakia began before being cut off by the leader,

“So, it was less a murder than a defeat”

“Do not rub our noses in it!” Shuri demanded,

“Silence!” M’Baku ordered whilst glaring at her, “I make the pronouncements here, girl”

“Look, uh, your highness,” Ross then stepped forward, with Catra raising an eyebrow at this, “the new king is a U.S…” M’Baku then hooted aggressively at him, clearly not getting the message, Ross continued, “the new king…” at this point all the Jabari gave their gorilla hoots in an aggressive tone, continuously for about ten seconds,

“Ross, do us all a favour and *shut up* !” Catra hissed, they couldn’t blow this chance! Once the hooting stopped, M’Baku glared daggers at the American amongst them,

“You cannot talk!” he barked, “one more word, and I will feed you to my children.” Ross gulped at this and Catra placed a protective arm around Shuri’s shoulders. After a heart-stopping moment, M’Baku smirked before saying, “I’m kidding. We are vegetarians” before chuckling at his little joke. Catra facepalmed at how corny that was before stepping forward, and straightening up,

“Great Gorilla M’Baku.” She announced as she got to her knees, and brought out the last Heart-Shaped Herb, showing it to the Jabari leader “this is the reason we have come here. We wish to offer this, the power of the Black Panther, to you. For there is a man on the throne of Wakanda who could cause great damage to both Wakanda and the planet, an outsider with a cold heart and no remorse, and only *you* can help us stop him” she remained on her knees as M’Baku rose, surprise etched on his face, which only grew as Nakia got down on her knees too, followed by Ramona and Shuri, and lastly Ross, it looked like M’Baku was about to accept the offer when he took a sharp breath,

“Come with me”

M’Baku lead them through the village and to a wooden hut that was also lacking walls, this hut had a dark wooden floor and had decorative raised fire pits leading to the entrance. Catra was wondering what the leader of the Jabari wanted them to see in there, but as they entered, the Jabari inside stepped aside to reveal a sight that made everyone gasped in shock,

“Impossible!” Nakia exclaimed as they approached this unbelievable sight; in the centre of the hut, a large square of the floor had been removed to show the snow-covered ground underneath the hut, and partially buried in the snow, was the still body of T’Challa! The Group quickly rushed to his side, Ramonda checking for any sign that he was still alive, “is he breathing?” Nakia asked,

“he’s in a coma.” M’Baku explained, “barely clinging to life. One of our fishermen found him at the edge of the river border, he brought him to me”

“Why do you have him in the snow?” Shuri demanded, but Catra knew the answer already,

“Because it is keeping him alive but in a coma state!” Catra pointed out, “come on Shuri, you’re intelligent, surely you know being frozen can keep you alive even when you are mere moments from death?”

“The cat girl is right” M’Baku nodded, “it is the only thing keeping him from joining the ancestors”

“We need to get him to my lab,” Shuri was clearly stressed by this, she refused to lose her brother again, “I can heal him there”

“Take him, he will be dead in seconds” M’Baku pointed out, Ramonda looked to the Etherian in the room at this,

“Catra, the Herb…” Catra nodded at this and handed over the precious flower, understanding that if it healed him from his fight with M’Baku, it could save him now.

Catra watched as Ramonda grinded the herb in a small pot with some heated water, forming a purple liquid once she was finished, she then held the steaming pot in both hands and said as she waved the pot over T’Challa’s body whilst looking to the heavens, “I call upon the ancestors. I call upon Bast. I am here with my son T’Challa. Heal him” at this, M’Baku looked away, giving Catra and Ross a look that told them that they too should avert their eyes. Catra did as she was told and turned her back on the ritual and gazed out on the snow-covered mountainside, she could still hear everything happening behind her, she heard Ramonda pouring the liquid into T’Challa’s mouth, “we must bury him. cover him. cover him!” she heard Ramonda announce hurriedly and she then heard the scraping and crunching of the snow as they supposedly buried T’Challa completely, she then heard the Wakandans chanting “praise the ancestors” in the Wakandan language,

“Wake up T’Challa” she heard Nakia whisper, and suddenly remembered when she too had been in this situation, the memory engulfing the Etherian.

Catra couldn’t believe this! Adora was dying in her arms, and it was all for nothing! Prime was corrupting the Heart of Etheria and his virus was taking Adora too! She screamed in pain as Catra held her close, she couldn’t just let this happen! With tears in her eyes, she called out to her,

“Adora! Please! You have to wake up! You can't give up. You have never given up on anything in your life. Not even on me. So don't you dare start now!”

“it’s too late,” she heard Adora murmur, “I’ve failed”

“No! No!” Catra hugged her tight, leaning her head on Adora’s chest and cradling her head with her hand, “I've got you. I'm not letting go.” She then took a deep breath and let out her biggest secret in one last attempt at bringing Adora back, “Don't you get it? I love you. I always have. So please, just this once. Stay!” she sniffled a bit at this, “stay” at that point, green lightning clashed from the Heart and just as one bolt was about to strike the two of them, a flash of light happened behind her, and as Catra looked, Adora had summoned her She Ra shield! She was protecting them and somehow breaking free from the effects of Prime’s Virus! Adora pushed herself up and held onto Catra for support with a surprised look in her eyes,

“You... love me?” she asked in disbelief, causing Catra to chuckle,

“You're such an idiot” she then looked right into her eyes and was surprised to see joy in those eyes when she had been moments away from death, she then said four words that would stay with Catra forever,

“I love you too.” Catra had no idea what came over her in that second, but she found herself leaning forward and pulling Adora closer, until before she knew it… they were kissing! Whatever happened next didn’t matter, because she had been wrong the whole time… Adora *did* want her!

A loud gasping was heard behind her, snapping Catra out of her flashback, she jerked around with hope shining in her eyes as she saw T’Challa sitting up in the snow, gasping for breath, she approached his side with a happy smile, whilst Nakia, Ramonda and Shuri made sure he was ok,

“Welcome back, your majesty” she said with her smile never fading, and as T’Challa took in his surroundings and started shivering from the cold, as he was still only in his shorts whilst still sitting in the snow, he grinned at his friends, family and allies before saying,

“Do you have a blanket?”

The Black Panther Lives

T'Challa had been given a warm brown robe to wear as well as a few blankets to warm him up. They were all in M'Baku's throne room, catching him up on the events after his "death"

"Killmonger has the full support of our military" Nakia announced,

"Not to mention he's now burned the garden of the Heart-Shaped Herb" Catra added, remembering the bonfire that had become of the sacred garden,

"Well of course he did" Ross spoke up at this, "that's what he was trained to do." Everyone looked at the American on hearing this, "his unit used to work with the CIA to destabilise foreign countries. They would always strike at transitions of power, like an election year or the death of a monarch. You get control of the government, the military…"

"Our resources!" T'Challa gasped, realising what Killmonger was up to,

"right" Ross nodded,

"The Great Mound!" the king exclaimed,

"Our Vibranium, all of my designs!" Shuri expanded on this, and Catra also realised what they were leading up to,

"he's going to send Wakandan weapons all over the world!" she exclaimed in shock, "the people of this planet won't stand a chance!" T'Challa stood up at this and approached Nakia and Catra,

"You must get them out of Wakanda safely" he told them whilst pointing at his family,

"What?" Ramonda questioned,

“What about you?” Shuri asked,

“The challenge will have to continue” T’Challa announced. Ramonda stood up and looked her son in the eyes,

“T’Challa,” she stated, “we will not leave Wakanda.”

“It is my duty to keep you safe” T’Challa argued, causing Shuri to also stand and face her brother,

“If he gets control of our technology,” she told him, “nowhere will be safe” she then brought out his Black Panther necklace and approached him, causing T’Challa to chuckle proudly, she then placed it over his head and around his neck as he dropped his blanket, “The Black Panther lives,” she announced, “and when he fights for the fate of Wakanda I will be right there beside him”

“As will I” Nakia pledged, looking at T’Challa the same way Catra would look at Adora,

“You can count me in” the Etherian grinned, “right now I really feel the need to blow something up, it might as well be something of Killmonger’s”

“I’m in too” Ross added, and with the confused looks the Wakandans gave him he smiled, “what? You’re gonna need all the help you can get” they all grinned at this, until a loud yawn filled the air. They all looked in the direction it had come from to see M’Baku just sitting in his throne, watching this whole scene play out, “are you done?” he asked sounding exasperated, “are you… are you done?”

“Could you give me and Lord M’Baku a moment?” T’Challa asked, and respecting the kings wishes, they all filed out of the room and down the hallways to the exit,

“Shuri?” Catra asked, “as much as I want to fight alongside you all, I feel like I will be at a *bit* of a disadvantage against the full force of Wakanda” she then gestured to the ripped suit she was still wearing, “this thing probably won’t hold up against the power

of Vibranium, even though it comes from another planet.” Shuri smiled at this,

“don’t worry” she chuckled, “I have a plan”

“I love this plan” Catra giggled silently, she, Shuri, Ross and Nakia were wearing blanket disguises to help them blend in with the Border Tribe warriors as well as balaclavas to hide their faces, they had managed to sneak T’Challa on board one of the flying Wakandan vehicles called Dragon Flyers. He also had a single Kimoyo bead which he was going to place next to the engine of the flyer, and on his signal, they would activate it and it would apparently explode! T’Challa assured them that, with his suit on, he would survive the explosion. So now they were hiding in the corridor that led to Shuri’s lab, waiting for the signal.

“Now!” they heard T’Challa call over the communicators they were wearing, Shuri then pulled off one of her Kimoyo Beads and handed it to Catra,

“You said you wanted to blow something up,” she explained as the Etherian took the bead in her hand, she saw the button, and with her eyes shining with excitement, she pressed the button. They could hear the explosion from all the way in the corridors,

“That was one of the best moments of my life!” she giggled like a schoolgirl,

“Ok, calm down” Nakia hissed, “wait for T’Challa’s signal” and a few moments later, they were given the go ahead,

“Shuri, now!” T’Challa’s voice came over the communicator,

“Copy that” Shuri responded as she led the way whilst the real Border Tribe warriors rushed to assist Killmonger.

As they entered the lab, there was one warrior left in there!

“abakhohlisi!” he shouted as he drew his sword! Catra frowned as she extended her claws, before backflipping over her friends and the approaching warrior, landing on all fours and using her momentum to spin around and kick the warrior’s legs out from under him, and before he hit the ground, Catra managed to get to her feet and catch him in mid-air before spinning him around and throwing him into the central column! “Ungubani?" he asked in shock as Catra approached him, she smiled before saying,

“NdinguCatra” the first thing that Shuri had taught her in the Wakandan language! Before landing a roundhouse kick to his head, knocking him out cold. They then proceeded to throw him out of the lab, with Catra refusing to kill someone for just following orders from a bad person.

“Nice one Catra!” Shuri praised her as they rushed down the spiral and to the main floor, Shuri then activated one of her sand tables and the sand quickly lowered to reveal numerous things concealed underneath, there was: two sets of Kimoyo Beads, two Ring Blades, Shuri’s panther Gauntlets, a set of Dora Milaje armour, but the thing that surprised Catra the most were the last few items, it was her armour, the one she had designed! Even the headdress was there, all the metallic parts were obviously Vibranium and Catra couldn’t even get any words out.

“No time for explanations” Shuri announced on seeing Catra’s gobsmacked expression, “just grab that armour, we can suit up on the go” she then laid out her plan once more, “Nakia, Catra and I will get control of the Royal Talon with this” she held up a Remote Access Kimoyo Bead on this,

“So, what do I do?” Ross asked, and Shuri quickly grabbed one of the Kimoyo Bead bracelets and put it on Ross’s wrist,

“you’ll have to fly it”

“What?!” the American asked in disbelief,

“You were a great pilot,” Shuri explained as she placed one of her communicators behind his ear, “don’t worry, I’ll guide you through it. It’s just like riding a hoverbike” she then pulled up another sand table alongside the first one, just waiting for the Remote Access Kimoyo bead to activate,

“What? You guys have hoverbikes?!” the man asked in disbelief, but Shuri had already rushed back to the first table.

“Hey, Nakia!” she called, “take that” she gestured to the Dora Milaje armour as she grabbed her gauntlets,

“I’m not a Dora” Nakia argued,

“Oh, for First-Ones sake!” Catra exclaimed as she grabbed her own suit whilst slipping on her new headdress, loving the familiar feel of it on her head, “its armour! Just put it on!” she also grabbed the second set of Kimoyo Beads and put them on her wrist, if she was going to fight for Wakanda, she was going to look like a Wakandan in *some* way.

“Come!” Shuri called from halfway up the spiral, with Catra and Nakia following “Good luck agent Ross!” the princess called back to the confused American

“I believe in you, Everett” Catra added as she followed her friend,

“we’re counting on you!” Nakia called, as she followed behind them, with Ross exclaiming,

“Yeah, I don’t know what I’m doing!”

The Battle of The Great Mound

The trio looked at the doors separating them from their inevitable fight. Catra was wearing her new armour, and she had to admit that it felt *incredible* , it was as if she was always meant to wear Vibranium. It was incredibly light, and it felt like she was just wearing her normal suit, yet she felt powerful enough to take on Horde Prime on her own! She glanced at either side of her, first to her left, seeing Shuri in her purple and gold battle armour with her Panther Gauntlets charged and ready, she then looked to her right to see Nakia in her Dora armour holding her, now glowing blue, Ring Blades. Both of them looked determined, and Catra smiled as she brought out her claws and glared forwards, ready to do what she had to do to help save this land.

The doors slid open to reveal the three warriors, instantly attracting the attention of two Border Tribe warriors, but as soon as they started advancing, Shuri sent Two blasts from her Gauntlets at them, blasting the enemies away!

"Neat!" Catra whispered, before they all started sneaking across the launch-pad they found themselves on. Down the hill they could see T'Challa and a majority of the Dora Milaje, led by Ayo, all fighting against the Border Tribe! The Royal Talon was parked nearby, and as Shuri brought out the Remote Access Kimoyo Bead, Catra quickly grabbed her wrist before she could throw it, "let me" she said with determination in her eyes. Shuri looked at the ship and then back at Catra before nodding and placing the bead in her hand. The Etherian wound up her arm, before tossing the bead high in the air. The thing arced in the air and landed perfectly on the roof of the Royal Talon!

"Nice shot!" Nakia commented with a small grin. Shuri then activated her communication device to talk to Ross,

"I made it American Style for you!" she hurriedly explained, "get in!" Catra guessed the princess was on about the interface that

Ross was meant to use to control the ship and was proven right a few seconds later when the Royal Talon raised its ramp and took off, blowing away two members of the Kings Guard as it did!

“YES!” the trio cheered as the mighty vessel took off,

“go!” Shuri called to Ross, “we can’t let those weapons get beyond Wakanda!”

“alright, I’m on it” Ross said calmly as the Royal Talon made a U-turn and started chasing after a few Dragon Flyers in the distance.

Catra’s eyes widened as she glanced over their hiding place and saw what was happening a few meters away! Okoye and two other Dora were fighting against someone who could only be Killmonger who was wearing the golden necklace version of the Black Panther suit! The Dora looked like they were actually winning! They landed blow after blow with their spears before trapping him in between the three!

“Tshixa!” Okoye shouted as all three of them did something with their spears that sent electrical energy flowing through the triangle that trapped the man! “mhliseni!” the general screamed as they kicked him to his knees! “fumana i-necklace!” they then repositioned the triangular lock hold to around Killmonger’s neck! “FUMANA NECKLACE YAKHE!” Okoye screamed as they edged closer and closer to the golden necklace around his neck! Killmonger was constantly grunting in pain as this was happening, but just as the dora were about to get to the source of his suit, he grabbed the spears holding him down and, to Catra’s horror, he got back to his feet and released a blast of orange coloured kinetic energy! Blasting the Dora’s down the hill!

“Right!” Catra muttered, “I forgot the new suits can do that” before glaring at the man, but remaining hidden, “ok, I’m sure we can do this” she whispered to her friends, “as long as we don’t

just rush in without a plan…" but before she could finish, Nakia threw her ring blade in the air, caught it and shouted,

"Wakanda Forever!" before charging right at the man with Shuri not that far behind,

"Just like that…" Catra tutted as she watched Nakia charge towards Killmonger, who grinned wildly before reforming his helmet over his head and pointing his sword at her and approaching her. Nakia threw her Ring Blades at the man, with him leaping over them and their wielder and landing on his feet, only to be barraged by repeated blasts from Shuri, who was at least staying a good distance away from him! Catra meanwhile was waiting for an opening! It was how she was always able to fight against Adora in the past, she knew Adora's every weakness… well every weakness except for her feelings towards her, but that goes unsaid! The issue here was that with the kinetic energy absorption abilities of the black panther suit, Catra couldn't find any weakness! Even *her* claws weren't strong enough to penetrate *Vibranium* !

"ok Shuri!" Ross suddenly called over the communicator, "I got 'em, what do I do?"

"First Ones give me strength!" Catra exclaimed, before screaming, "SHOOT THEM DOWN YOU IDIOT!"

"alright!" Ross responded, he was clearly too in awe at the technology to register the insult Catra had sent him.

Nakia suddenly landed a blow to Killmonger's back, causing them to get into a close quarters fight whilst Shuri was hitting her target with her gauntlets every time she blasted at the fake king! Nakia managed to disarm him of his sword, before doing the same with his shortened spear! But as the woman attacked again, he caught her arms and ducked under the attack, slashing her leg

with his claws! Nakia screamed in pain as he grabbed her arm and threw her down the hill!

"Nakia!" Catra gasped, why couldn't she see any way of winning?! She used to never give up! There was always a way to win! Meanwhile, Shuri was now going one on one with Killmonger! She sent continuous flows of sonic energy from her gauntlets that managed to force the man to the ground! She then advanced on him, and it looked like Shuri was about to take him down! But then he grabbed his shortened spear and broke one of her gauntlets with it whilst grabbing and crushing the other with his claws! He then threw the girl to the ground! Catra then felt something awaken deep within her, she then realised why she was always able to get back up when she was knocked down! She was angry with Adora for betraying her at the start! She was then able to fight through the irritation of Adora's friends at first when she turned over a new leaf, but then she was able to fight seriously when confronted by something that threatened the woman she loved! She would fight to protect *anyone* she cared about!

Killmonger raised his spear and was about to drive it into the princess's heart when a firm hand grabbed his wrist! He was then kicked in the gut, which more pushed him back due to his suit, he looked to see an armoured Catra glaring at him,

"Hey, Erik" she smirked as she brought out her claws and charged! She slashed! She punched! She kicked! Dodging every attack the outsider threw at her, constantly keeping him away from her best friend! she used her bracers to block every swing that got too close for comfort and acted like lightning as she never struck the same place twice! Every blow she landed she made sure wouldn't be on a place she had already hit! Shuri watched the wild Etherian as she attacked, her blows clearly taking Killmonger by surprise, but she had also noticed a golden glow building up around the suit he was wearing! Catra noticed this too as Killmonger kicked her across the launchpad! She tumbled over herself before landing on all fours, using her claws to spin herself around to face the man,

“you’re tougher than you look, Wildcat” he announced as he saw the girl recover,

“Only Scorpia can call me that!” the Etherian screamed as she charged at him once more! She leaped in the air, pouncing at the man! She half flipped in the air, so her feet were facing Killmonger, and as she landed, she put all her force into kicking at the man’s chest! Causing all the stored Kinetic energy to blast her into the air! As she span through the air, Catra grinned, just as she planned! She aimed at a nearby pillar, caught it with her claws, and used her momentum to spin around it before launching herself in the same direction she came from! Killmonger noticed the Etherian and readied his spear, but just as he was about to impale the flying cat, Catra caught his arm, pushing it to the side as she clenched her fist and landed a blow to his head with so much force that he was knocked to his knees! She then transitioned into a spin as she raised her left leg to disarm the false king, but what she was not expecting was to have her leg get caught in mid-air by the man before spinning her around by said leg and throwing her into the pillar! As her focus came back and the ringing in her ears died down, Catra could only helplessly watch as Killmonger once again advanced on Shuri who was now backed up against a massive hole that led to the mines that Catra enjoyed watching so much! The drop was devastating, she doubted that anyone could survive a fall like that!

“what’s up, princess?” he asked as he advanced on the downed royal, Catra could swear that a purple flash happened in the corner of her eye at this

“you’ll never be a true king” Shuri responded defiantly, he grinned madly at her as he reformed his helmet and raised his spear, but just as he was about to end the girl… T’Challa came in out of nowhere, tackling Killmonger as he charged, and they both fell into the hole, with Shuri screaming,

“Brother!” as they fell!

The Tide Turns

After a heart stopping minute of silence, Catra was starting to worry that she had been right about the hole and that T'Challa was dead for real this time, when suddenly T'Challa's voice came over the communication devices,

"Shuri!" he called, sounding slightly out of breath,

"Brother!" the Wakandan princess responded with worry etched on her face as she gazed into the hole,

"Turn on the train on the bottom track!" he ordered, making Catra's eyes widen, realising what he was up to,

"T'Challa!" she exclaimed, "Those stabilizer things down there will deactivate your Panther Suit! You won't have any protection!"

"Neither will he!" T'Challa responded with determination, confirming that Catra was right, he was going to use the Stabilizers to weaken Killmonger's defence! Clever!

"Ok!" Shuri nodded before grabbing one of her Kimoyo Beads, causing the whole bracelet to glow red,

"Good luck Your Highness!" Catra called as she helped Shuri to her feet, "are you sure you can still fight, Princess?" she checked, causing the Wakandan to smile as she picked up a Vibranium Spear that was dropped by the Dora Milaje from earlier,

"Positive!"

The duo quickly slid down the hill towards an injured Nakia, who was hissing in pain from the scratches Killmonger had inflicted upon her.

"Nakia!" Catra called out as they approached the warrior,

“Are you alright?” Shuri asked whilst quickly checking her wound, which wasn’t as bad as it could have been,

“I’m ok” Nakia nodded, “you?”

“Yes,” Shuri said hurriedly whilst handing her her Ring Blades “what about you Catra?”

“I’m good” the Etherian grinned as she brought out her claws, “I always land on my feet”

“let’s go” Nakia announced, before the three of them charged down the hill and into the fray. As they were nearing the battle, Ross’s voice once again came over the communicators,

“Shuri, I’ve lost one of them but two are on my tail!” what followed was a loud boom, “what was that?” he asked, clearly something was happening in the lab!

“The lab is under attack” GRIOT’s voice echoed, answering his question,

“What? where?” the CIA agent questioned in shock,

“Deactivating hologram” GRIOT announced, and Catra knew that the sand tables faced the windows!

“Ross!” Shuri shouted, they were only a few meters away from the fight now, “you have to get out of there now!”

“Why are we worrying?” Catra asked, “those windows are made of Vibranium, right?”

“NO! why would they?!” Shuri exclaimed in disbelief,

“Hold on! You mean to tell me that Vibranium is the metal that makes up practically *everything* in Wakanda, and you didn’t think about reinforcing *glass* with it?!” Catra shrieked,

“If we survive, I will take note of your point!” the princess called back, “now get out of there Ross!”

“How long have I got?” Ross asked calmly, resulting in GRIOT once again answering him,

“Glass integrity is at 50%”

“Put me back in” the man announced with determination, clearly ignoring Shuri’s protests. At that point they finally entered the battle of the hill, and Catra unleashed her fury on all who opposed her! The Etherian blocked sword blows from her opponents with her bracers whilst throwing her own assaults in the mix, she used everything in her ability in that fight; headbutts, claw slashes, punches, kicks, she even launched herself at one unfortunate warrior, and performed a flying leg scissor move around his neck, throwing him to the ground before she landed a quick but strong punch to his head, knocking him out. She was keeping herself under control this time, she knew that all of these men were only fighting them under the orders of an evil person, there was no need to take their lives for that.

Even with the added assistance of Catra, Shuri and Nakia, it still didn’t help the fact that they were greatly outnumbered, and something that Catra wished she had been told of before joining the fight, was that the blankets worn by some of the Border Tribe warriors weren’t just for show! They used these blankets to create blue energy shields that even Catra couldn’t break through. They were all soon surrounded by the Border tribe, using these shields to box them all in, and Catra could clearly see that there was no chance of continuing fighting now they had the upper hand and could strike whenever they wanted. W’Kabi, who for some reason was riding on an armoured rhino, rode up to the trapped warriors,

“surrender now!” he shouted, “you have three seconds to lay down your weapon, One!” Catra glared daggers at the man who had only recently been T’Challa’s trusted friend, “Two!” Catra’s

ears then twitched, was she hearing things? No, she could clearly hear lots of people hooting like gorillas! W'Kabi' eyes widened in surprise as the whole tribe tried to understand where the sound was coming from, when suddenly, W'Kabi was lifted clear off his rhino! And behind him, standing on a large rock, holding W'Kabi with one hand, was M'Baku!

"Witness the might of the Jabari!" he yelled proudly, waving his staff in the air as he talked, "FIRSTHAND!" he then threw the struggling warrior into one of the Border Tribe shields, just as hundreds of Jabari warriors attacked the Border Tribe from behind! This caused all their opponents to scatter!

"PHAMBILI!!!" Okoye yelled as they all re-joined the fight, now with the tables turned, the Border Tribe were now on the losing side!

Catra was in her element in this fight! Still sticking to her new resolve to only incapacitate and not kill, she was still able to do serious damage! Suddenly, one Border Tribe warrior charged at her with his sword raised! He brought it down towards her head, and the Etherian was quick to cross her arms and use her bracers to catch the sword, the warrior was strong and was able to push the Etherian to her knees! Just when Catra was unable to keep this up, a Vibranium spear smacked into the man's side, sending him flying! Catra didn't move from her position, stunned that someone had just technically saved her life!

"You are welcome" Okoye nodded at her with a smile, before looking at her posture and nodded once more before saluting her and running back into the battle. Confused, Catra looked down and saw that she had finally done the salute right! Her arms were crossed right over left!

"Ha!" she exclaimed in joy, before flipping back to her feet and charging forwards with her claws out, screaming, "WAKANDA FOREVER!!!"

The Battle's End

Catra was acting *wild* on the battlefield! She knocked out numerous opponents with little to no issues! At that point, she noticed W'Kabi charging at her! She quickly flipped backwards and whilst doing so landed a strong kick to his jaw! The Border Tribesman stumbled back and wiped blood from his now cut lip,

"it is my job to protect Wakanda from outsiders like you" he spat, "I should never have let the princess bring you in,"

"and yet you allow an outsider to take the throne and almost kill your friend?!" Catra announced, "you've got the terms "duty" and "revenge" mixed up mister!" W'Kabi screamed in anger as he charged with his blade raised. Catra blocked and dodged every attack he threw at her, using her cat-like reflexes to her full advantage! When she brought out her claws and landed a few gashes to his side, arms and back, he glowered at her,

"you say I am mixed up, when you pretend to be the Black Panther?!" he yelled, "Shuri claimed that your friends are lost like you, maybe somewhere on earth? Well you can be sure I will find them for you, and finish them *all* ! FOR WAKANDA!" the Etherian growled at this, he can threaten her all he wanted, but to threaten Glimmer, Bow and Adora! He just crossed the line! She charged right at the man, tackling him to the ground! W'Kabi punched her hard on the cheek, sending her to the ground, he then raised his sword, but just as he was going to finish her, Catra swept his legs out from under him, and at the same time removed her headdress and got back to her feet, and as W'Kabi was about to get up, Catra span around and slammed the Vibranium headdress against his face, sending him back to the ground, stunned! The Etherian leaned down and grabbed his head with one hand, partially pulling him up to face her,

"for what you just said about my friends, I should kill you" she held her other hand in front of the man's face, extending her claws and flexing her fingers ominously, "and if you had found me

a few years ago, then maybe I would, but nowadays, I keep trying my best to be the best I can be, and you are right, I'm not the Black Panther, I'm just someone who is willing to help in any way I can. She then retracted her claws, clenched her hand into a fist, "but this is for threatening my friends and my girlfriend" before punching him hard in the face, knocking him out! "Boy! That felt good!" she chuckled, before rushing over to join Shuri, who was having a bit of trouble with the Border Tribe warriors.

"Hey, Shuri!" Ross called over the communicators,

"Ross! Seriously the worst time!" Catra interrupted as she kicked away a Border Tribe warrior, Shuri was doing well with the Vibranium spear, using it to send energy pulses at her opponents, but that didn't hide the fact that the spear was bigger than her! So Catra helped out by knocking back anyone who got too close to the princess,

"Yeah?" Ross asked sarcastically, "Well, the last cargo ship is almost at the border, but they got me trapped with some kind of cables!"

"Make an X with your arms!" Shuri called as she blasted another warrior,

"Sonic Overload initiated," GRIOT's mechanical voice announced, and after a few seconds, Shuri then shouted,

"Now break it!" they could hear Ross grunt as he did as Shuri instructed, followed by GRIOT announcing,

"System rebooting in 5, 4, 3, 2, 1… System rebooted" a few seconds later, a triumphant Ross called over the communicator,

"Yes!" he screamed, "we did it!"

"Good on you!" Catra nodded, "now get out of there!" she then noticed something, W'Kabi was back on his feet and was also back on his rhino! He was charging straight at M'Baku!

“LOOK OUT M’BAKU!” she screamed, rushing to the Jabari leader’s aid, but just as they were about to collide, Okoye stepped in, out of nowhere, between the two, causing the rhino to stop in its tracks, coming to a halt just in front of her before licking her cheek. W’Kabi quickly dismounted and approached the general, reaching for his sword,

“Drop your weapon” Okoye ordered,

“Would you kill me, my love?” W’Kabi asked, making Catra remember all the times she had been in this situation, with Adora fighting against her, all for the sake of her new home. She knew now that what she had done was wrong, and she understood that those actions would live with her for the rest of her life.

“for Wakanda?” the general announced as she raised her spear, “without question!” at this, W’Kabi drew his sword, Okoye looked worried at this, but then he looked back at the battlefield, with lots of innocent lives being lost, from both sides, he then looked at Okoye and threw his weapon to the ground and got to his knees. At this, the rest of the Border Tribe knew it was over. They all started throwing down their weapons and surrendering.

“its over” Shuri gasped with happiness, but Catra looked past Okoye and W’Kabi, back at the hole where T’Challa and Killmonger had fallen,

“not yet…” she muttered before sprinting across the battlefield, up the hill, and diving into the hole!

Catra used her claws on the wall of the hole before coming into the hollowed-out cavern of glowing blue Vibranium, she then used all her strength to jump from train track to train track, making her way down to the bottom. She could still see T’Challa and Killmonger fighting to the death, both their suits glowing with Kinetic Energy. She made one final jump and landed on top of a Sonic Stabilizer but instead of helping the king, she just watched.

This was the end of the Ritual Combat, and the odds *must* be fair.

The Stabilizers suddenly activated, and then the train came rocketing past! With the suits deactivated, numerous patches of the combatant's skin was exposed, and Killmonger still had his shortened spear, which was even shorted now, so it would be better to just call it a blade. T'Challa caught the blade in Killmonger's hand and started pushing it towards his neck! Killmonger was pushing back! He managed to push the blade away from himself and towards T'Challa, pushing him to the edge of the tracks! It took all of Catra's willpower to not intervene!

"This is it for you cousin!" Killmonger grinned,

"You can do this T'Challa!" Catra couldn't help calling out, T'Challa jerked his head towards the noise, and his eyes widened, the end of the train was fast approaching! He then did something that Catra did not expect to see: T'Challa pushed the man back, who swung at him, before T'Challa caught his arm, knocked the blade high into the air, and just as the Stabilizers turned off as the train zoomed away, he rolled the both of them forwards, caught the blade, and rammed it into Killmonger's chest, *just* before his suit reformed! That was the same move she had used in Busan! T'Challa had copied her! Said king then removed his helmet breathing heavily, Killmonger did the same, hissing in pain,

"Heck of a move" he grunted, gripping the blade with both hands,

"Well, I learned from the best" T'Challa responded whilst glancing at Catra, who jumped down from her position on the Stabilizer and approached them. Killmonger looked at them both, still grunting in pain and breathing heavily, but now he was also crying,

"My pops said Wakanda was the most beautiful thing he'd ever seen," he sniffed, "he promised he was going to show it to me

someday. You believe that? Kid from Oakland running around believing in fairy tales." He then winced in pain once again, Catra couldn't help but feel sorry for him, even after all he had done, she knew how he felt to have a promise snatched away from you, how it felt to lose a family member, to blame the whole world for it. T'Challa got to his feet and pulled Killmonger up,

"help me, Catra" he said, and without hesitation, the Etherian rushed to the downed man, and wrapped his right arm around her shoulders whilst T'Challa did the same for his left, they both made sure to keep a firm hold on the blade, making sure it didn't move as they made their way to a nearby lift, and rode it to the mouth of the mine.

As they exited the mine, Catra saw they were at the edge of a cliff underneath a giant carving of a black panther and the sun was beginning to creep down over the horizon showing the beauty that was Wakanda. They both helped Killmonger to the edge, and then lowered him to the ground, so he was kneeling, watching the sunset. They then stood by him as he watched, with Catra feeling glad that she could help deliver on his lost father's promise. Killmonger's breathing was laboured at this point, each breath sounding even more wheezy than the last.

"it's beautiful" he sighed,

"yes, it is" Catra nodded, before kneeling down to the man and placing a kind hand on his shoulder, "I'm sure your father would be happy to know you got to see it," T'Challa looked down at the dying man and then got to his knees too,

"Maybe we can still heal you" he stated, looking him in the eyes without obscuring his view of Wakanda. Killmonger turned his head to face the king,

"Why?" he asked, "so you can just lock me up? Nah. Just bury me in the ocean with my ancestors that jumped from the ships. 'Cause they knew death was better than bondage" and then, to

Catra and T’Challa’s shock, he pulled out the blade from his chest, with his suit covering the deep wound as it was removed, grunting one final time with the pain whilst looking at Wakanda’s beauty before going limp with Catra’s hand being the only thing keeping him upright. He was finally dead.

A single tear fell down Catra’s face as she gently lowered Killmonger’s body and closed his eyes. T’Challa then leaned over and crossed the man’s arms in the Wakandan salute. No words were spoken by either of them, they just watched over his body as the sun set, and with it, Killmonger’s short rule. It was now finally over.

The Purr-fect End

The next day, things all went back to normal in Wakanda… almost; almost half of the border tribe were mourning the losses of their warriors who died in the battle. Shuri's lab had been completely destroyed, so Shuri had invited Catra to stay in her room for the night. Not to mention the numerous ships that had been destroyed needed replacing quickly. There were good things that happened too though; T'Challa was on the throne again, M'Baku was given a place in the council, and Ross had agreed to keep Wakanda's secret from his government. But by far the biggest thing to happen was that Catra had been summoned to face the council herself.

She was nervous, Okoye and Ayo were leading her to the throne room where she would face the judgement of T'Challa and the Council. She was still wearing her armour from the day before, as her Etherian suit still needed repairs, and she knew what was going to happen and was ready to accept her fate. Two Kingsguard members opened the doors for them and the two Dora's behind her ushered Catra into the throne room, she instantly noticed T'Challa, who was back on his throne and wearing a long black robe with colourful patterns on the lining and the cuffs. Ramonda was sitting next to him and also present were the elders of the Tribes, Nakia and M'Baku. Catra entered the room as far as the Dora's went, stopping about five meters from the clay centre, before saluting the king,

"ungasondela" T'Challa smiled, before beckoning her to come over to the centre. Catra gulped before approaching. She stopped right in the middle of these authority figures, knowing exactly what was coming. "I assume you know why you're here, Catra" the king announced, and Catra smiled sadly, glancing at the Elders, then Nakia, then M'Baku, and then Ramonda before looking back at the king,

“Yes, Your Highness,” she nodded, “I understand that I am an Outsider, just like Killmonger, and you all cant risk me being like him, so whatever it is you have to do, be sure I will accept whatever you have planned, I never *really* belonged here. It was an *honour* to fight for this place though. I have been to many different worlds, but none of them compare to the beauty of Wakanda. So thank you for this opportunity” she then closed her eyes and hung her head, waiting for T’Challa’s word.

“you are most welcome, Catra…” he started, “but by the sound of things, you do *not* know why you have been summoned before the council,” Catra opened her eyes in a snap and raised her head quickly, looking T’Challa in the eyes, he wasn’t joking, “according to numerous of the living Warriors of the Border Tribe, you were the one who fought against them before they blacked out, and according to numerous witnesses, you had the chance to kill W’Kabi, but instead incapacitated him, would you care to explain yourself?” Catra was definitely not expecting this, she quickly cleared her throat before looking around at the council, all of whom were looking straight back at her,

“well,” she began, “I was like them… a soldier, for an evil group called the Horde. I knew what I was doing was bad and I even enjoyed it, but every time I fought against my best friend, who had betrayed us and joined the resistance, she had numerous chances to kill me for what I did, yet she didn’t, neither did her friends, so when I turned and joined their side, I expected them to never forgive me, but they did. Adora even became my best friend again, we even became closer than that… so when I was fighting against people who knew what they were doing, but were only following orders from an evil person, I refused to take their lives to pass on that chance to do the right thing in the future that I was given without any good reason.” T’Challa smiled at this,

“So, you know,” he announced, “those warriors may be in custody, but their families all wish to extend their thanks to you for sparing them”, Catra grinned a little at this, “and it is because of this choice, and the fact that you looked after my family when I was

assumed dead, that I wish to offer you a position in the palace. Please get down on one knee”

“What do you mean?” the Etherian asked whilst doing as she was told, completely confused at why T’Challa would do this. She looked up at him with confusion in her eyes, and he grinned again, before standing,

“This is the start of a new age for Wakanda,” he announced, as Okoye joined him by his side, now holding a red cushion, “and with a new age comes a new position in the council.” He then picked up the item on the cushion, which was in fact the same necklace that T’Challa had placed around his neck after winning the ritual combat with M’Baku. The king raised it proudly and placed it around Catra’s neck, “may I please present… Captain Catra, my number two,” he then took her hands and helped her to her feet, “though still answerable to me” he explained, “she will have full access to all facilities Wakanda has to offer, and she has now officially become… a member of Wakanda” T’Challa then nodded towards the corner of the room, causing Catra to turn around to face Shuri who had the recording function of her Kimoyo Beads open and facing them, “its live” T’Challa whispered, causing the Etherian’s eyes to widen in surprise, “say something”, Catra took a few deep breaths, looked down at the ceremonial necklace around her neck, before looking straight at the camera and saluting the nation whilst shouting proudly,

“WAKANDA FOREVER!” the elders and her friends repeated the action, T’Challa included, echoing her cry,

“Wakanda forever!” and then, Catra’s highly tuned ears heard from outside, the whole of Wakanda also echoing her cry,

“Wakanda Forever!” followed by cheers and applause, which was repeated by the people around her. She smiled widely, feeling proud of herself, and… for the first time in a long time, she felt at home. She had found a home.

Catra found her first duty as Captain Catra was to accompany the king and Shuri on a journey in the newly rebuilt Royal Talon (Ross had apparently destroyed it by ramming the last cargo ship with it). They arrived discretely, keeping the ship camouflaged in the sky, they approached a group of abandoned buildings with a group of kids playing basketball (some form of sport apparently) in a car park. They were all wearing casual clothes, with Catra once again wearing her hooded coat to hide her catlike ears as well as slip on trainers. Shuri was wearing a black skirt with a white t-shirt complimented by a jacket with a colourful pattern on it and black and white lace-up shoes. And T'Challa was wearing black trousers, a black t-shirt, a black trench coat and black leather boots, all this complimented with his Panther necklace. The trio gazed through a wire fence at the building T'Challa had brought them to, with Shuri clearly being confused,

"When you said you would take me to California for the first time," she announced, "I thought you meant Coachella, or Disneyland. Why here?" T'Challa leaned one hand against the fence, looking up at the building.

"this is where our father killed our uncle" he stated, taking Catra and Shuri by surprise with how blunt he was being about this, Catra then noticed that there was a large sign on the building stating the building was condemned,

"looks like its going to be torn down," she pointed out,

"good" the princess beside her said calmly,

"they are *not* tearing it down" T'Challa corrected them, before announcing, "I bought this building." He then nodded towards the building on the right of the first, "and that building" he then nodded towards the building on the left, "and that building over there… this will be the first Wakandan International Outreach Centre." So this was the supposed "big change" T'Challa had been planning for the last few days, "Nakia will oversee the social outreach," the king explained before tuning to face his sister, "and

you will spearhead the science and information exchange.” Shuri looked at her brother in shock at this statement,

“you’re kidding!” she exclaimed in disbelief,

“eh?” T’Challa responded before pressing a button on one of his Kimoyo Beads, causing the Royal Talon to de-cloak and descend to land in the car park! All the kids playing stopped on seeing the ship and all flocked over to look it over with one young boy staying behind in awe. T’Challa and Shuri did their secret handshake before the princess went over to the ship to explain this thing to the kids.

“Hey, yo!” the young boy called as he approached T’Challa and Catra, who both looked at him kindly, “is this yours?” they both glanced at each other with a knowing look, “who… who are you?” he asked, causing the two cats of Wakanda to grin widely.

The End

The End Credits Scene 1

Four days later, Catra was rushing through the palace's halls, after all this time you'd have thought she would have gotten used to this place, but she always had a habit of getting lost in corridors. She had been summoned by T'Challa to meet a man who would be staying in Wakanda for a bit, as she finally arrived at the door of the room she was meant to be at, she could hear T'Challa talking to an American sounding person, though it was too noble sounding to be Ross.

"Thank you for this" the man said,

"Your friend and my father," T'Challa said sadly, "they were both victims. If I can help one of them find peace…" a slight pause followed, before the man announced,

"You know if they find out he's here" he pointed out, "they'll come for him"

"Let them try" T'Challa responded with confidence, then footsteps approached the door and opened it, revealing a room with white walls and lights with a black floor and a black ceiling, and one wall was similar to Shuri's lab, in which it featured a continuous window that showed the outer view of the Vibranium mine, with the panther carving in plain view. T'Challa led Catra into the room and over to the only other person in the room: it was a white man with short blonde hair that showed off his forehead, he was incredibly muscular and was wearing a simple blue zip up hoody as well as brown cargo trousers, "Captain Catra," T'Challa announced, "may I introduce you to Captain Steve Rogers"

"Just Steve Rogers will do" the man announced modestly, but Catra still gasped at this, this was *the* Captain America! Shuri had told her that he was even the *First Avenger* ! She quickly gave him the Wakandan salute,

“it’s an honour to meet you, sir” she announced, “welcome to Wakanda”

The End Credits Scene 2

Just over two months later, Catra had settled into Wakanda perfectly, her Xhosa had even been improving every day, but now came an important day in T'Challa's new campaign to open Wakanda to the world. She (with her hood up), Nakia Okoye and Ayo were following the king through a building called the United Nations Assembly Building, where T'Challa had arranged to address the whole UN. As they approached some stairs, a familiar face walked down to greet them,

"Agent Ross" T'Challa smiled as they approached the man,

"Your highness," Ross greeted, shaking his hand, "Okoye, Ayo, Nakia, Catra" he nodded to them,

"Please give us a second," T'Challa told them, and the three of them walked over to the foot of the stairs,

"So, how is your therapy going, Catra?" Nakia asked quietly. Catra had told her and Shuri about her nightmares and the guilt she kept facing, so they had gotten her in touch with a Wakandan therapist who had diagnosed her with PTSD, she was glad she wasn't going to die from this condition, and the therapist was actually qualified for their job, unlike Glimmer (no offence to the princess, it was just that the qualified therapist was better). She had been attending weekly sessions, getting better at opening up about how she was feeling about her past. And she was improving,

"No nightmares for about a month now" she announced proudly, "so we are definitely making progress" at that point, T'Challa re-joined them and they all started heading up the stairs, before Ross called out,

"Oh, uh, T'Challa." They all turned to face the man who took a deep breath before clearing his throat and saying, "ithamsanqa kunye nemitya yezihlangu ezininzi" causing the Wakandans to

chuckle, he meant to wish the king luck, but accidentally said "good luck and many shoelaces"

"It was close" T'Challa admitted through the giggles of his entourage, "it was close" before joining in with the chuckles

"don't laugh, I practiced that," Ross chuckled back,

"enkosi Everett" T'Challa thanked the man, "enkosi" before leading them up the stairs.

They entered a circular room full of smart people of numerous origins, they all died down as T'Challa and his Entourage approached a main podium that overlooked the whole room, cameras flashed as T'Challa stepped forward and spoke into a microphone on the podium,

"My name is King T'Challa, son of King T'Chaka." He announced to the crowd "I am the sovereign ruler of the Nation of Wakanda and for the first time in our history we will be sharing our knowledge and resources with the outside world. Wakanda will no longer watch from the shadows. We cannot, we *must* not. We will work to be an example of how we as brothers and sisters on this Earth *should* treat each other. Now more than ever, the illusions of division threaten our very existence. We all know the truth: more *connects* us than *separates* us. But in times of crisis, the wise build bridges, while the foolish build barriers. We must find a way to look after one another, as if we were one single tribe."

"With all due respect, King T'Challa" one man said into his own microphone, "what *can* a nation of farmers have to offer the rest of the world?" Catra grinned at this, as did Nakia, Okoye and Ayo, T'Challa also grinned, knowing that what they had would blow these people's minds.

The End Credits Scene 3

Unbeknownst to Catra, almost a year earlier, another golden vortex opened in the training courtyard of an ancient training facility. There was one person to bear witness to this spectacle, they were unsurprised as they watched the vortex pulse with energy before depositing a short, stocky, pink haired girl onto the cobbles. The onlooker gazed at the stranger, before raising their hands, with a brass two-fingered ring on their left hand which they kept still, whilst they circled their right arm in an anticlockwise motion, causing an orange sparking hole to form underneath the girl, dropping her into the unknown,

"welcome to earth" the onlooker announced, before closing the hole and walking away.

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